

GI'AC MY

The Game of Tactical Combat in Vietnam

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a Fantac Game



GIAC MY

from

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INTRODUCTION

Giac My is designed for miniature wargaming involving the recent conflict in Southeast Asia. Several aspects are covered in these rules that are normally not found in other wargaming rules for the modern period, such as tunnel warfare and punji sticks. Although large formal battles can be fought (and sometimes were in Vietnam), the main thrust of this rulebook is guerrilla and counter-insurgency warfare.

Giac My is designed to simulate small unit combat in Southeast Asia, but it can be used for 'liberation wars' anywhere, or small unit infantry combat in general. Obviously, many facets of unconventional warfare are difficult to simulate in a gaming format. However, we have tried to include whatever is applicable (and feasible) for tactical level engagements of a reasonable size. We hope that these rules will be well received by those interested in modern miniature wargaming.

Special thanks go to Rod Burr, Roland Foerster, George Elliot, and Arnold Hendrick for their help in playtesting and developing the ideas for Giac My, and to General Westmoreland, General Giap, Ho Chi Minh, Lyndon Johnson, and the Vietnamese people without whom this game would not have been possible.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

<u>SECTION</u>	<u>PAGE</u>
Introduction	1
Required Equipment	3
Time and Distance Scale	3
Movement	4
Fatigue	5
Visibility	6
Weather	7
Fire Combat	8
Small Arms To Hit Table	9
Small Arms Characteristics	10
Heavy Weapons	12
Misses and Scatter	14
Indirect Fire	14
Forward Observers	15
Indirect Fire Table	15
Field Artillery	16
Casualties from Shells, etc.	18
Grenades and Grenade Launchers	19
Armored Vehicles	20
Casualty Effects	25
Flack Vests	25
Medics and First Aid	25
Morale	27
Pungi Sticks and Mines	30
Hand to Hand Combat	31
Static Defenses	33
Tunnel Warfare	36
Aircraft	37
Air Mobility	39
Tear Gas	40
Troop Types	41
Organization, Weapons and Ammo	43
Geography of Southeast Asia	45
Glossary	47

REQUIRED EQUIPMENT

The players will need a means of generating random numbers between one and twenty. The rules assume that twenty-sided dice (available from your hobby dealer) will be used, but chips in a container or an electronic random number generator can be used.

Several six-sided dice will be required.

The players will need at least one tape measure for both movement and range measurements. Rulers will be useful for movement.

Miniature figures, models of soldiers and equipment, are needed for playing pieces, unless the players are willing to forego the visual effect of miniature figures, in which case, paper counters or anything else can be substituted.

An excellent line of miniature figures for this period is available from: Johansen Miniatures, 4249 East 177 Street, Bronx New York 10465.

TIME AND DISTANCE SCALE

Game scale is: One inch equals ten meters.

One turn is forty seconds.

To increase playability, the rates of fire for all weapons have been reduced and their effectivity increased (This is common practice in tactical land miniature rules).

Turn sequence:

Each turn the player shall:

- 1) Roll for move and counter move. (Each side rolls two six-sided dice, the side with the higher total will move first (move) and the side with the lower total will move second (counter move).)
- 2) Plot indirect fire and designate units performing covering fire (in secret).
- 3) Side A moves (move).
- 4) Side B moves (countermove).
- 5) Both sides perform covering fire. Units that did nothing previously in that turn and did not perform cover fire may act as observers.
- 6) Both sides perform regular observation and fire.
- 7) Indirect fire effects occur.
- 8) Hand to hand combat (melee) takes place.
- 9) Return to Phase one.

Morale checks are taken as needed, in whatever phase that they occur.

In one full turn troops may perform any two of the following actions:

- a) move
- b) mount (vehicle or beast)
- c) dismount
- d) get up from prone, or climb out of foxhole.
- e) act as forward observer for indirect fire.
- f) fire
- g) reload
- h) draw weapon
- i) sheathe weapon
- j) throw grenade or place satchel charge
- k) observe for hidden weapons
- l) clear trail
- m) drop equipment
- n) pick up equipment

Falling prone and hand-to-hand combat do not count as actions.

Movement:

Each figure and vehicle has a Base Movement Allowance which is characteristic of that figure or vehicle. Movement is based on the subtraction of Movement Factors (MF) from the Base Movement Allowance (MA) of the unit moving. Each inch of movement across a particular type of terrain costs the number of MF listed in the movement cost tables for the terrain and the kind of unit moving.

<u>Unit Type:</u>	<u>Movement Allowance:</u>
Infantry	12
Light Wheeled Vehicles	36
Heavy Wheeled Vehicles	30
Fast Tracked Vehicles	30 (light armored vehicles)
Medium Tracked Vehicles	24 (medium tanks)
Slow Tracked Vehicles	18 (bulldozers, etc.)

<u>Terrain Type:</u>	<u>Terrain Cost Table</u>			
	<u>Infantry</u>	<u>Two-Wheel Dr.</u>	<u>Four-Wheel Dr.</u>	<u>Tracked</u>
Paved Road	1	1/2	1/2	1
Dirt Road	1	1	1	1
Open hard ground	1	1-1/2	1	1
Soft ground	2	4	2	1-1/2
Deep mud	6	24	8	4
Low grade	+1/2	+1/2	+1/2	+1/2
Medium grade	+1	+2-1/2@	+1	+1
Steep grade	+3	+6-1/2@	+3	+2
Broken/rocky	2	6	3	2
Firm sand	1	4	2	1-1/2
Loose sand	3	8	4	2
High grass	2	2	2	2
Swamp	4	2*	2*	2*
Water #	2 (wading)	1*	1*	1*
Medium vegetation	+1/2	+2-1/2	+2	+1
Jungle/heavy veg.	+2	+22-1/2	+5	+2
Turn 90°-180°	-	+1	+1	+1
Turn over 180°	-	+2	+2	+2
Tunnel: enter/				
exit	4	-	-	-
normal	4	-	-	-
vault room				
or main corridor	2	-	-	-
bottleneck				
(crawl)	8	-	-	-

@ Use four-wheel drive cost if on road.

* Amphibians only

Fording, costs twice the cost for the bottom terrain.

Note; vehicles moving in reverse travel at half speed.

Special movement costs:

A man crawling uses four times the cost for the terrain. Irregardless of the terrain costs a man can always move one inch.

A vehicle cannot cross terrain for which it does not have sufficient movement factors to move at least one inch. Any vehicle which enters such terrain cannot move.

Terrain Type notes:

High grass; For movement purposes high grass is grass three feet or higher (up to fifteen feet). For combat and visibility purposes, high grass is grass up to four feet tall. Grass which is over a man's head blocks visibility and is treated as jungle/heavy vegetation for visibility and combat.

Medium vegetation: Low underbrush, trees at least ten feet apart.

Heavy vegetation: Heavy underbrush or closely spaced trees.

(Note; closely spaced trees stop vehicles.)

EXAMPLE:

A U. S. squad (2nd squad, 3rd platoon, Alpha Company) is moving cross country on an APC (armored personnel carrier) which is a fast tracked vehicle. They are going across open hard ground, so they move 30" in a turn (the APC has a Movement Allowance (MA) of 30, and the terrain movement point cost is 1 MP per inch for a fast tracked vehicle in open hard ground). On the next turn they are coming to rough ground, broken and rocky, with a hill behind it. The APC moves 3" (cost 3 MP) to reach the rough ground, and then 2" through it (cost 4 MP). Now the

APC starts up the hill which is a medium slope. The ground is still broken so the movement cost for 1" is 2 MP (broken terrain) plus +1 (medium slope) for a total of 3 MP per inch. The APC moves 3" up the slope (cost of 9 MP) and the terrain changes to open hard ground, so the cost per inch becomes 1+1=2. The APC continues up 5 more inches (cost of 10 MP) and is then on top of the hard ground in medium vegetation. The cost per inch here is 1+1=2, so the APC moves 2" (cost of 4 MP) and stops, since it has used up all 30 of its movement points. The squad now dismounts, which they can do since they can perform two actions per turn. They cannot move any further after dismounting because they have already moved this turn (being on the APC while it moves counts as moving for this) and therefore they have now done both their actions. In the next turn, they move their full movement allowance (12) which allows them to move 8" since the terrain cost for them is 1-1/2 per inch (1 MP for hard ground plus +1/2 for medium vegetation). This movement cost them 10 fatigue points, as we will see in the next section.

Fatigue (Optional):

In order to simulate the effects of fatigue on individuals, all actions performed by figures shall have costs in fatigue points which will be subtracted from a Base Fatigue Point Allowance (See Troop Types). When the figure's remaining fatigue points are one fifth or less of its Base Fatigue Point Allowance, the figure is tired. His movement allowance is reduced by half and he can only perform one action per turn, instead of the normal two. In hand-to-hand combat, modify the figure's die roll with a -2. Any figure whose fatigue point total falls to zero or less is exhausted, and must remain stationary resting. The figure can perform no actions except firing with a -1 adjustment to his To Hit die roll, or fighting (at -1) if engaged in hand-to-hand combat.

<u>Action:</u>	<u>Fatigue Point Cost (cumulative)</u>
1 - 4 MF (walking)	-1
5 - 8 MF (trotting)	-3
9 - 12 MF (running)	-10
engaging in fire fight	-3
hand-to-hand combat	-20 (-25 if wearing Flack Jacket)
clearing trail in light/med vegetation (walking speed)	-1
resting*: standing	+2
lying or sitting	+6
setting up heavy weapon	-2

*Can only rest when not exposed to fire. If resting in combat, but under cover, only receive half value.

Note; No figure can accumulate a fatigue point value higher than its Base Fatigue Point Allowance.

<u>Troop Fatigue Types:</u>	<u>Base Fatigue Point Allowance</u>
U. S. elite, NLF cadre, ROK regulars (those that served in Vietnam), Montagnards, Pathet Lao cadre, Nungs.	180
NVA reg., NLF reg., ARVIN elite, Khmere Rouge, Pathet Lao reg.	150
U.S. reg., ARVN reg., Australian and New Zealand reg.	120
U. S. draftees, ARVN strikers, all militia	100

Visibility:

With modern weapons the best defense is not to be seen. This makes the distance that a unit can be seen in various types of terrain very important.

The distances given on the Visibility Table are the maximum distances in inches that an observer can spot the object specified in the given terrain. Personnel may search an area 6" x 6" square each turn for hidden enemies/objects, or two such areas if they do nothing else that turn. (Vehicle crewmen who do not perform any action associated with driving or fighting the vehicle may search two areas.) Using field glasses, infra-red or starlight scopes always counts as observing, that is it uses up one of the two actions allowed per turn.

Personnel and objects can be seen at one-half the normal distance by anyone looking in the right direction, as opposed to searching an area.

Any unit in the open that is not camouflaged (except for prone or crawling troops) is seen if there is an observer within visibility range and facing in the right direction. The observer need not be searching the exact spot where the sighted object is unless the observer is using field glasses, an infra-red scope, or a starlight scope. Moving vehicles in brush and any units that fire are treated the same way. Prone troops count as a foxhole for detection purposes, and crawling troops count as stationary standing.

Any unit that fires while an enemy is searching a 6" x 6" area that the firing unit is in is spotted. Firing reveals the firer only on the turn he fired. An observer must keep watching the spot without performing any action that would take his eyes off of it or the position is lost. It is assumed that an observer keeps watch unless he is expressly ordered to perform some action that would preclude it.

The distance to the horizon is assumed to be 300 inches, unless the observer is on a hill.

The visibility table assumes that all units are wearing appropriate dull colors or camouflage uniforms (and vehicles are camouflaged painted). If anyone should go into battle with bright colored uniforms, scarves, etc., he will be visible at twice the normal distance (or to the horizon, whichever is shorter). This includes the large white stars on the sides and front of U.S. vehicles (unless painted or mudded over), etc.

EXAMPLE:

Returning to the U.S. squad on top of the hill, they have moved to the edge of the vegetation and are looking down into the areas around. The weather is overcast.

The squad leader, SSG McRed, is searching an area 30" away in medium vegetation with fieldglasses. (Most of the distance between the observer and the area he is searching is open.) In the 6" x 6" area he is searching there is a VC who is prone and stationary. He is not spotted since he can only be seen 9" away by an observer with fieldglasses in this weather (the overcast cuts the 12" from the visibility table to 9"). As his second action the squad leader observes another 6" x 6" area next to the first. In this there are two veteran NLF cadre troops who are moving. They are spotted because the observer could see them at 150", times 75% because they are veteran troops and do not disturb the vegetation as much as normal troops (note a on the visibility table), minus 25% due to the overcast, which is still 150" $(3/4) (1-1/4) = 84"$, which is greater than 30".

Meanwhile the other members of the squad have been observing also. There is a squad of VC moving in the open 286" away. The troops would normally see this at any range (out to the horizon) but due to the overcast they can only see this out to 75% of the horizon. The normal horizon is 300", but from a low hill it is 400", so 75% of this is 300", so the VC are seen by the U.S. troops.

At the same time another VC soldier is moving through tall grass 69" in front of the U.S. squad. They will see this at 75% of 100" or 75", if they are searching the correct spot, but if they are not, they can only see it at half that distance (assuming they are looking in the right direction, which they are here) or 37-1/2". Most of the squad does not see that VC, but PFC Martin is searching the correct spot and sees him. Until PFC Martin can point the VC out to the others, only he sees him. Martin is the only one who could fire at that VC. To point him out, PFC Martin would have to tell the other infantrymen where to look, and they would have to search that area (counting as one action) before they see him.

Visibility Table:

Observer:

<u>Object:</u>	<u>Stationary with field glasses:</u>	<u>Stationary:</u>	<u>Moving on foot:</u>	<u>Troops in/on moving vehicles:</u>
In the open:				
large stat.object	H	H	H	H
moving troops	H	H	150	75
stat. troops	H	200 ^a	100 ^a	50 ^a
prone troops/ foxholes	200 ^a	10	5	2
In high grass or broken terrain:				
moving vehicle	H	H	150	75
large stat.object	H	200	100	50
moving troops	H	100 ^a	50 ^a	24 ^a
stat troops	200	12	6	3
prone troops/ foxholes	C	C	C	C
In medium vegetation:				
moving vehicle	200	50	25	12
large stat.object	60	20	10	6
moving troops ^a	150	24	12	6
stat. troops	36	10	5	2
prone troops/ foxholes	C	C	C	C
In heavy vegetation:				
moving vehicle	50	24	12	6
large stat.object	12	8	4	2
moving troops ^a	6	4	2	1
stat troops	2	1	C	C
prone troops/ foxholes	C	C	C	C

C = Contact, under 1/2"

H = to horizon (normally 300")

a) green troops are visible 150% range, veteran troops are visible to 75% range.

Bright colors double the visibility range. Camouflaged positions halve the range of visibility.

Adjustments to Visibility Table

<u>Condition:</u>	<u>Adjustments:</u>
In heavy vegetation	10" max. line of sight through
In medium vegetation	40" max. line of sight through
In tall grass	75" max. line of sight through
From low hill	Add 100" to horizon distance
From high hill	Add 300" to horizon distance
Dawn, dusk	Subtract 20% from visibility range
Light rain (or overcast)	Subtract 25% from visibility range
Heavy rain or night with moon	Subtract 50% from visibility range
Dark night	Subtract 90% from visibility range
Infra-red scope at night	Treat as night with moon, 50%

Weather:

Wind strength is determined by rolling a six-sided die, and subtracting one from the roll. A result of zero means still air. There is a one-sixth chance per turn of the wind strength changing. If a change occurs, determine the new wind strength as it was done initially.

At the start of the game, wind is assumed to be from a random direction. Roll a die to determine the direction. Wind direction can change on any turn (however, a check need not be made unless requested by one of the players). Wind direction changes: one point counter-clockwise on a roll of one, one point clockwise on a roll of two, randomly determine the new direction on a roll of six, and otherwise it is unchanged.

There is a one-third chance of rain. Check this at the start of the game, and every game scale hour (ninety turns) thereafter, if heavy rain. Otherwise, it will be light rain. At the start of each turn of rain, roll two normal dice. A roll of twelve and the rain ends at the end of the current turn. After a heavy rain, there is one-third chance of light rain. After any rain, there is a one-half chance it will be overcast. Overcast lifts on the same die roll as rain ending.

If it is not raining at the start of the game, there is a one-sixth chance it is overcast. This too should be checked every game scale hour.

There is no air support during heavy rain except from transport helicopters and B52's (see section on air support).

Fire Combat:

Weapons fire is handled by rolling a twenty-sided die, making adjustments to the result, and comparing the adjusted result to a TO HIT NUMBER obtained from the combat table. The number rolled is adjusted for various factors such as range, target cover, concealment, etc. If the adjusted die roll is greater than or equal to the TO HIT NUMBER, a hit is scored.

When a hit is scored, a normal (six-sided) die is rolled to determine the effect of the hit. See the table on wounds.

Automatic Weapons: Any weapon that can fire bursts, as opposed to a single round, is considered an automatic weapon. Automatic weapons may be fired at one target or at all of the targets within an area. The target area can be either a 2" diameter circle or a 6" by 1" rectangle (actually it should be an ellipse, but for playability the rectangle is easier) with the long axis (the 6" direction) in the direction of fire, e.g., if the weapon is fired due north, the rectangle is placed with the 6" axis north-south and the 2" axis east-west.

Automatic weapons receive a bonus adjustment to their die roll, a +6 if they are firing at one target, or a +3 if they are firing at all the targets within an area. (If there is only one target in the area, but the firer elected to fire at the area rather than at a specific target, e.g., he is firing blind into cover, the +3 bonus is given.)

Number of Hits: When a target is hit by an automatic weapon, more than one round may score. Roll a normal die. If the target is a vehicle-sized object, the number on the face of the die is the number of hits. If the target is man-sized, a three or less means one hit, a four or five means two hits, and a six means three hits. Each hit must have its effect rolled for separately.

Grazing fire, Deadspace and FPL: Grazing fire is fire such that the path of the rounds is parallel to the ground. The line of fire is close enough to the ground that if anyone moves through the area, they can be hit. Deadspaces are areas where the line of fire is so high off the ground that a man can walk over the ground without being in danger of being hit, because the fire is over his head. Gullies, etc., are the usual causes of deadspaces. Any time the ground is not level or evenly sloped, there will be deadspaces in the line of fire unless the fire is aimed so low that it hits the ground at the first high point, and thus stops.

A FPL (Final Protective Line) is a preset line of fire (set with stakes or known settings on a tripod mount) such that a wall of fire is set up. When an automatic weapon fires an FPL any unit that crosses the line of fire (except in an area of deadspace) receives fire at a +6 bonus and without target movement or concealment adjustments.

Cover Fire:

Units designated to perform cover fire are the only units that can fire during the movement phase of the turn. These units cannot move in that turn. They can fire at any enemy unit they see, and such fire takes place before the end of the movement, so if a unit which is moving from cover to cover is fired on while moving, it does not get the benefit of the cover. Any unit destroyed by cover fire cannot return fire in the normal fire phase, since it has already been destroyed.

Units performing covering fire who are armed with repeating weapons can fire again in their regular fire phase if they do not act as observers, etc., during that phase. The second fire is a separate action. Both of the figure's two actions for that turn have been used up firing. Only units armed with small arms and light weapons (up to HMG) can do this. Otherwise, they must spend the later phase reloading.

Units that do not move may observe during the cover fire phase. If they spot anything they may fire at it during their regular fire phase. Units that observe during the normal observation and fire phase cannot fire on hidden units they spot until the next fire phase.

Pinning Fire:

Troops are pinned if either during the previous turn or an earlier phase of the current turn they were: the target (including any figure within the area of fire of an automatic weapon) of a direct fire weapon (or within one inch of a target figure), or within twice the C2 radius of an HE (including concussion) or WP burst. Even if adjustments to the firing die roll make a hit impossible, fire will still pin. Pinned troops suffer a penalty to their die roll and may require a morale check if they try to advance.

Dazing:

Troops who are within the KZ of an HE burst (including frag grenade), or within the CZ of a concussion grenade or Demo charge are dazed. Dazed troops do nothing else that turn except fight (at -3) if they are attacked hand-to-hand. Troops who are dazed roll a normal die every turn after they are dazed. A roll of five or six is needed to recover from dazing. (Dazed troops do not receive plus fatigue points.) A roll of one or two on the recovery roll lets standing dazed troops go prone. Note: Troops head down in foxholes are not dazed by rounds smaller than 100mm (Note, grenades are smaller than 100mm) unless they are wounded by the round.

TO HIT TABLE (small arms):

Base Number: 8 (one always misses)

Target is:

Walking	-1	Trotting	-2
Running	-3	Kneeling (cover through waist)	-2
Crouching/prone (cover through chest)	-4	In foxhole	-6
Prone w/cover	-5	Kneeling w/cover (as next to a tree)	-3
In light vegetation	-1	In medium vegetation	-2
In heavy vegetation	-4	Partly obscured	-4
Not visible	-8	A vehicle	+2
Visible for more than 1/2 turn	-1	Vehicle moving more than 12" per turn	-4
Visible for less than 1/2 turn	-2		

Firer is:

At short range	+0		
At medium range	-2	(-1 if with scope and stationary*)	
At long range	-4	(-2 if with scope and stationary*)	
At extreme range	-8	(-3 if with scope and stationary*)	
Walking	-1	Prone or w/rest	+2
Trotting	-3	Kneeling	+1
Running	-6	Weapon on tripod	+3
On fast-moving vehicle (10" or more per turn)	-8	On slow-moving vehicle (less than 10" per turn)	-4

Previous consecutive rounds fired at this target +1/round

Firer is under fire -2

Firer is weapons crew under fire -1

Firer is pinned -5

Firer is wounded -1/wound

Autofire at single target +6

Autofire at area +3

Firer is in melee - Weapon is:

Pistol	-2	SMG or short auto carbine	-3
Rifle	-5	Shotgun	-4

*One round per phase

Note: Crew served weapons cannot fire in melee.



ON WATCH - ACHAU VALLEY, 1968

Small Arms:

<u>Weapon:</u>	<u>Range:</u>				<u>RoF</u>	<u>Mag</u>	
	<u>Short</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Long</u>	<u>Extreme</u>			
M16**	12"	24"	32"	45"	4,A	20,30	20 rnd mag, if over 18 rnds loaded 1/6 chance to jam.
AR15	12"	24"	32"	45"	4	20	Full turn to clear.
M14	14"	30"	42"	50"	3	20	
M14 mod.	14"	32"	48"	60"	3,A	20	bipod
M1 rifle	15"	30"	45"	50"	3	8	
M1 carbine	8"	15"	22"	27"	4	30	
M79/203	6"	12"	24"	40"	1		min range 4", HE shell.
with flechette	1"	3"	6"	8"	1		TO HIT as auto weapon.
M60 MG bipod	16"	36"	56"	80"	A	275	Belt fed.
M60 MG tripod	18"	45"	72"	110"			
Car 15	8"	15"	24"	30"	4,A	30	
BAR	14"	28"	36"	50"	A	20	W/bipod TO HIT as M14 mod.
AK47	10"	20"	30"	36"	3,A	30	
PPSH 43*	4"	9"	15"	20"	A	31	Drum held 70
Pistol*	1"	3"	5"	8"	3	Various	
M3A*	4"	9"	15"	20"	A	30	
Sten/Austin*	4"	9"	15"	20"	A	30,20	
M14 Sniper	18"	36"	54"	72"	2	20	Bipod and scope
RPD	14"	32"	46"	60"	A	40-75	drum, from rest
.50 cal MG	18"	45"	90"	150"	A	250	belt
FN-FAL	14"	30"	42"	50"	3	20	
FN-FALO	14"	32"	48"	60"	3,A	20	bipod
SKS	12"	24"	32"	45"	3	10	
Nagant	15"	36"	54"	64"	1	5	values from rest
AR10	10"	20"	30"	45"	3	20	over 16 rounds, 1/6 chance jam, full turn to clear
Shotgun*	4"	8"	12"	16"	2	6	
area of effect:	short 1-1/2", medium 3", long 4-1/2", extr. 6"						
TO HIT bonus:		+8	+4	+0		-4	
FN-MAG	16"	36"	56"	80"	A	250	belt, bipod
	18"	45"	72"	110"	A	250	belt, tripod
M1917A1	18"	45"	72"	110"	A	250	belt, (water cooled) tripod
M1919A4	18"	45"	72"	110"	A	250	belt (air cooled) tripod
M1919A6 bipod	16"	36"	56"	80"	A	250	belt (air cooled)
14.5mm MG	18"	45"	90"	150"	A	250	belt
12.7mm MG	18"	45"	90"	150"	A	250	belt
ZPU 12.7mm	18"	45"	90"	150"	A	750/barrel	1,2, or 4 barrel mounts
Thompson SMG*	5"	10"	16"	22"	A	20,30	
Type 50 SMG*	4"	9"	15"	20"	A	35	
Crossbow*	5"	10"	15"	20"	1		Must be reloaded each time.

*Round may be stopped by flack vest.

**1967 to late 1968, each phase you try to fire an M16, if autofire is attempted, there is a 1/6 chance the weapon will jam; if semi-autofire, there is a 1/36 chance the weapon will jam. The jam is cleared by a roll of six, each roll counts as one action.

Marksmanship:

Class:	A	+1 at close range, +1 at medium range, +2 at long and extreme range.
	B	+1 at medium to extreme range
	C	normal
	D	-1 at long and extreme range
	E	-1 at short range, -2 at medium to extreme range.
	F	-2 at short to medium range, -3 at long and extreme ranges.

- A - Snipers
- B - US elite, local force snipers
- C - Other U.S., NLF cadre, British regulars, Western elite.
- D - Western regulars, ROK (serving in Nam), NVA, NLF regulars, ARVN elite
- E - ARVN regulars, Pathet Lao, etc.
- F - Local forces

EXAMPLE:

The U.S. squad we have been following now opens fire on the enemies it has observed. It is a new turn. The squad leader fires at the two NLF cadre he sees 30" away. He does this in the cover fire phase of the turn, and he is using tracer ammunition. The APC's .50 cal HMG and part of the squad open fire in the normal fire phase at the spot where the tracers hit, even though they cannot see the enemy. The rest of the squad continues to watch for other enemy troops.

SSG McRed is armed with an M16. 30" is long range for this weapon, and he fires a burst (6 rounds) at the two enemy who are both within a 2" diameter circle. He rolls a twenty-sided die twice and gets a twelve and a seven. His adjustments are: Target is walking -1, in medium vegetation -2, long range -4, and autofire at an area +3, for a total of -4, so his die rolls become eight and three. The eight is a hit, while the three is a miss. Both VC are pinned.

The man hit may be hit more than once, since it was an automatic weapon. A normal die is rolled and a two results, which means he is only hit once. (The effect of the hit is explained later.)

Now in the normal fire portion of the turn the VC are fired on by the APC's HMG, two riflemen and a grenadier with an M79. Since the VC were fired on they have gone prone. The rifles and the HMG are firing bursts, the M79 fires one round. PFC Williams and PVT Turket each have M16's, so their adjustments are: Target prone -4, long range -4, autofire at area +3, and -8 since the target isn't visible, so they must roll twenty-ones to hit. Neither of them do (obviously) but they keep the VC pinned. On the next turn they will need twenties to hit, due to the bonus for consecutive shots. Each has now used 6 rounds. PFC Williams had 18 rounds in his magazine and so has 12 left. PVT Turket had 20 rounds in his magazine and has 14 left, but must roll for a jam since he had more than 18 rounds in the magazine. He rolls a six on a normal die and so his weapon has jammed. It will take him all next turn to clear it.

Sp4 Johnson fires the HMG and rolls a five and a nine. His adjustments are: target prone -4, medium range (for the HMG) -2, target not visible -8, autofire at area +3, total -11, so a nineteen is needed to hit, and he misses. The VC are still pinned.

Sp4 Banner fires the M79 and rolls a seventeen. His adjustments are: target is a point of ground (where he saw SSG McRed's tracers hit) no adjustment, at extreme range -6. Therefore a fourteen is required to hit and he does. Therefore the M79 shell lands in the area, which we will assume is the center of the area SSG McRed fired at. We will discover what effect the shell has later, but to get slightly ahead of ourselves, the shell has a 1" CZ (Casualty Zone) and both VC are inside it and must be rolled for.

Although we are getting ahead of ourselves we will complete the effects of the hits. The explanations will be found in later sections.

The man hit by one round from the M16 was Fred the Red. Rolling for casualty type (normal die) we get a four, so he is WIA. Rolling for wound type (normal die) we get a two, which means he has a serious wound. Now we roll for him again since he is in the CZ of the HE shell. We roll a four (on normal die) so he is not hit by this. (If he were standing he would have been.) His buddy Kim Dye is also rolled for from the HE shell, a six is rolled so he is a casualty. Rolling for casualty type, we get a one, which is KIA, so Kim Dye does.

To Hit Number of Heavy Weapons vs. Stationary Targets in Open

	10"	25"	50"	75"	100"	150"	200"	250"	RoF	HE Effect As:
LAW	4	6	11	18					1	c.
3.5" RL (Bazooka)	4	8	14	20					1	d.
RPG	3	6	11	18					1	d.
57mm RR	3	5	9	14	18				1	d.
75mm RR	3	5	8	11	16	20			1	lt. mtr.
90mm RR	3	6	10	15	19				1	lt. mtr.
106mm RR	2	4	5	6	9	14	18	20	1	mdm. mtr.
37mm	2	4	5	6	9	12	16	20	2	b.
40mm	2	4	5	6	9	12	16	20	6	b.
US 76mm	2	3	5	6	8	11	16	20	1	lt. mtr.
US 90mm	2	3	4	5	5	6	11	16	1	mdm. mtr.
US 105mm	2	3	3	4	5	6	9	11	1	105 How.
Sov. 76mm	2	5	6	9	11	16	20		1	lt. mtr.
Sov. 85mm	2	3	5	6	8	11	16	19	1	mdm. mtr.
Sov. 100mm	2	3	5	5	6	10	12	16	1	105 How.
6" Gun/Launcher	2	3	5	5	6	8	12	16	1/2	155 How.
Field Artillery (DF)	2	3	5	6	7	8	12	16	1	.

Note: A roll of one is always a miss.

- a) It is assumed that ammo appropriate to the target is used. Direct hits kill all men or animals. For other than direct hits, see Indirect Fire.
 b) HE round has CZ = 1/2".
 c) Equivalent to M79 round.
 d) Equivalent to Frag Grenade.

Modifications to Heavy Weapons Die Rolls:

Target moving 2" or more	-2
Target moving 20" or more	-4
Attacker moving 1" or more	-4
Attacker moving 10" or more	-8
Target visible less than 1/2 turn	-2
Target visible less than whole turn	-1
Target partly obscured	-4
Previous consecutive rounds same target	+1/rnd
Target size: Man or tree	-2
Prone man	-6
Foxhole	-8
MG emplacement	-6
Door (3' x 7')	-4
Window (3' x 3')	-6
Small building	+5
Vehicle, Field Art. position, etc.	+0
AT gun position, etc.	-2
AFV under fire (from weapon which can kill)	-1
Gun with crew pinned	-5
Gun with crew under fire	-1
Weapon not on mount (57, or 75mm RR only)	-2
Gunner wounded	-1/wound

Flechette TO HIT Table:

Roll a six-sided die.

Weapon:

All*

$\frac{6"}{2}$

Range:
 $\frac{12"}{3}$

$\frac{18"}{4}$

-1 to die roll if
target prone, -2 if
target in foxhole
(with head up)

*US 76, 90, and 105mm gun, and 105 and 155mm How.

Flechette round covers a cone which is 6" wide 18" from the weapon.

Armored Vehicle Crew Classes (Optional):

The marksmanship of tank (and similar vehicle) crews is very important in combat. The use of this optional rule is highly recommended.

Western Crews

ROK, ARVN elite Crews

ARVN, NVA elite Crews

NVA

Basic Table

-1 at long range, -2 at extreme

-1 at short range, -2 at medium and long, -3 at extreme

-2 at short range, -3 at medium,

-4 at long or extreme

EXAMPLE:

Moving right along, the VC who SSG McRed didn't see now tries to make that oversight fatal. Luke the Gook is 30" away from the APC and fires at it with an RPG. The APC is partly hull down, count as partly concealed. At 30" the RPG has a To Hit Number of eleven. Adjustments are: target partly concealed -4, vehicle +0, so a fifteen is needed to hit (i.e. Luke must subtract 4 from his die roll and still have an eleven to hit, so he must roll a fifteen). He rolls a ten and misses. Since the shell must land somewhere, we roll for scatter. It is at medium range (30" is between 25% and 50% of the weapon's maximum range of 75") so there is a 1/2 chance the round scatters one to three inches in a random direction, roll a die and 4+ it does, 3- it doesn't. We roll a two, so it doesn't. Therefore, it scatters 1 to 20 inches long. We roll a three, so the rocket hits 3" (30m) behind the APC. No one is in the CZ.

On the next turn the squad returns Luke's fire. None of the squad are pinned, but they have been fired on. Specialist Banner reloaded his M79 as his second action last turn, and so can fire now, but he wishes a better chance to hit and goes prone first, which also makes it less likely he will be hit. Although going prone does not count as an action, it still prevents him from firing in the cover fire phase, because if he is to fire cover fire, it must be the first thing he does. Private Turket is still working on clearing his weapon, but Pfc Williams will fire his M16 and Sp4 Green fires his M60. Williams fires a burst of six rounds (leaving six in his magazine) and rolls an eight on the die. His adjustments are: target prone -4, target in medium vegetation -2, no target concealment (the backblast was clearly visible, and Williams' eyes have not left the spot), long range -4, Williams is under fire -2, autofire at single target +6, total -6, adjusted die roll is 2, a miss. Luke is pinned. Sp4 Green is standing and cannot use his LMG's bipod, therefore, the M60 counts as a M14 with a rate of fire = "A". He rolls a twelve and has the same adjustments as Williams (30" is medium range to a M14, but we assume Green is on the other side of the APC and has a range of 30-1/2", so he is at long range) so his adjusted roll is six, a miss. The gunner on the APC fires the .50 cal and rolls a three, his adjustments are: target prone -4, in medium vegetation -2, medium range -2, firer weapons crew under fire -1, weapon on tripod +3, autofire at single target +6, total +0. He misses. SSG McRed is already prone (we didn't mention that before, but he went prone while the squad was firing at the spot he had marked) and fires four shots on semiautomatic. His adjustments are: target prone -4, in medium vegetation -2, long range -4, firer under fire -2, firer prone +2, total -8. He rolls a one, which is an automatic miss. For his second shot, he rolls a seven, and receives an extra +1 adjustment for second shot, so his adjusted die roll is 7-8+1=0, a miss. For his third shot, he rolls a ten, which gives an adjusted roll of 10-8+2=4, still a miss. The sergeant's last shot gets a roll of thirteen, and 13-8+3=8, a hit. Rolling for casualty type we get a roll of 4, WIA. Our next roll of six tells us that Luke is only lightly wounded. This completes the cover fire, we can now do regular fire, including Luke who spent the turn reloading his RPG, but we will stop the example here.

Misses and Scatter:

Misses with HE, WP, smoke & illumination rounds scatter to some point other than the location they were intended to land. This location has to be determined.

Thrown grenades scatter one inch from their aiming point. See the grenade rules.

Direct Fire Weapons:

At close range there is 1/2 chance of a 1" scatter as follows: Roll a normal die; 1, 2 short, 3 left, 4 right, 5, 6 long. Otherwise the round scatters 1" - 20" long. Roll a twenty-sided die to determine the distance.

At medium range there is a 1/2 chance that the round will scatter 1" - 3", as above. Roll a normal die and divide the result by two (rounding up) to determine the distance scattered. Otherwise, the round scatters 1" - 20" long, as before.

At long range there is 2/3 chance the round will scatter 1" - 6", as above. Otherwise, it scatters 1" - 20" long, as above.

At extreme range, the round scatters 1" - 10" in a random direction. Roll a die to determine the direction of scatter.

The only weapons in the small arms table for which scatter occurs are the M79 and M203 grenade launchers. See Grenade and Grenade Launcher rules.

For scatter purposes, heavy weapons ranges are divided into four classes; short, medium, long, and extreme. Short is out to 25% of the maximum range shown on the To Hit Table, medium is from 25% to 50%, long is from 50% to 75%, and extreme is over 75%. The US 105mm Gun has a maximum range of 300" (3km), with a To Hit Number of 16 over 250".

Hits due to Scatter or Indirect Fire: The scale of the board in *Giac My* is approximately 1 to 400 (1" = 10m), but most of the figures that are available are approximately 1 to 72 in scale, so a figure that represents something 1' wide, appears 6' wide on the board. This may cause indirect fire rounds or rounds that scatter to appear to hit some target when, if the scale was correct, they would actually be near misses. Therefore, whenever an indirect fire round or a scattered round seems to hit, roll a normal die. If the adjusted die roll is greater than or equal to the Base Number (5), a direct hit has been scored. Otherwise, it is a near miss (the object is within the KZ).

Base Number = +5

Object Size:	Small building	+3
	Large vehicle	+1
	Small vehicle	+0
	Man size	-1

Indirect Fire:

There are three types of indirect fire: observed fire, blind fire, and prepared fire. In all three cases, the target is a point of ground. The fire is called in during phase two, and hits (either the intended point of ground or a scatter point) in phase seven. Anything which appears to be a direct hit is rolled for to determine if it actually is in the same way as if the round had scattered to that point.

Observed fire is where the point of ground is visible to either the weapons crew or a forward observer. Blind fire is where the intended target point is not visible to anyone on the firing side. Note that this assumes a system of hidden movement is used. If the players can see all the units on the table, those that are invisible by the rules should not be fired on. In this case, the players may plot blind fire before the start of play. This fire schedule can be terminated at any time, with a delay of one turn from the time the termination order is given, but once terminated, it cannot be resumed. If a hidden movement system is in use, the players are free to call in fire mission on any point on the board which they suspect may contain enemy units. In both cases, a twenty-sided die must be rolled to determine if the point is hit or if the round scatters.

Prepared fire: This is fire at a registration point or at a stated distance and direction from the registration point. For example, 3" over and 2" left. Registration points can be set before the start of play, or established during the game. A written list of registration points must be kept for each side.

Units which are not familiar with the area cannot call fire onto registration points until they have seen a marking round (usually smoke by day and flare by night) fired onto the registration point they want to use. Of course, if they see a registration point used (hit by artillery fire) by another unit they can use that point if they are told that it is fire on a registration point.

Conduct of Indirect Fire:

There are three steps in calling in indirect fire. Step one, the Forward Observer must determine the point to be hit (see Forward Observer Rules). Step two, the artillery Fire Direction Center (FDC) must calculate firing data, and the F.O. must spot the rounds and adjust the fire as necessary. This is covered by the INDIRECT FIRE TO HIT NUMBER TABLE. Step three, the shells scatter due to minor random variations. This small variation happens to every round, including the rounds in step two, which are used to adjust fire.

FORWARD OBSERVERS:

All indirect fire must be called in by a Forward Observer (F.O.). The FO must inform the FDC where the round is to land (the Aiming Point). Before an FO can call in a fire mission, he must have observed the target point on the prior turn. The target is observed in one turn, and the fire is called in and lands on the next turn. To simulate the possibility of the FO making a major error in the coordinates of his Aiming Point, a check must be made for FO error each time firing an Aiming Point is designated. If the FO makes an error, the round is assumed to be so far off target as to not be visible to the FO ('round lost'), and the FO must redesignate the Aiming Point, again subject to the above rule. (Minor errors in Aiming Point coordinated are included in the Indirect Fire To Hit Number roll.)

Fire missions planned from a map, such as blind fire, will always have the right coordinates. This type of fire should not be allowed unless some form of hidden movement is used, or all such fires are plotted and the turn on which they occur specified before the start of play.

For the FO to get the Aiming Point right, he must roll a seven or better on two six-sided dice. A table of adjustments to the die roll follows.

FO Die Roll Adjustment:

FO is/has:

Specially trained FO	+3
In a prepared position (cannot receive landmark bonus)	+4
NCO or officer (Specially trained FO cannot receive this bonus)	+2
Moving	-1
Weapon crew acting as own FO	+5
On a moving vehicle	-2
Pinned by enemy fire	-1
Militia	-1
Readily identifiable landmark is visible	+3

Note: An FO who has already had artillery fire land in his sight, which he called in, now has a readily identifiable landmark in sight (for purposes of FO Die Roll Adjustments). As long as he continues to call in fire, without any extended gaps, on targets in the general area of his previous fire, he continues to receive the readily identifiable landmark is visible bonus.

As shown in the turn sequence on page 3, indirect fire is plotted in phase two. Unless the crew of the weapon are acting as their own FO, or the fire is at a preplanned registration point, the FO must have observed the target in the previous turn. Fire at a registration point still needs an FO, but he can do the observing as the first of his two actions that turn, and call in the fire mission as his second function.

Once the FO's Aiming Point coordinates are correct, proceed to step two. Roll a twenty-sided die, consult the Indirect Fire Table and make the appropriate adjustments to the die roll.

Indirect Fire Table:

To Hit Number = +16 (2 or less always misses)

Adjustments to die roll:

Weapon: Light Mortar (Lt. Mtr.)	-1
8" Howitzer	+1
Soviet Rocket	-2
Target Partly Obscured (does not apply to blind fire)	-2
Previous consecutive turns of fire on same target (does not apply to blind fire)	+3/turn
Blind fire	-2

If the adjusted die roll is less than the To Hit Number, the Aiming Point scatters 2" to 40" in a random direction from the designated target.

Random Scatter:

Step three is the determination of shell scatter around the Aiming Point. All shells scatter up to 5" from their Aiming Points. Roll a six-sided die for each round and subtract one from the die roll. The result is the inches of scatter from the Aiming Point in a random direction. A scatter distance of zero (i.e., a roll of one minus one) means the round hits the Aiming Point. Note: For playability, this step can be omitted for single rounds whose Aiming Point has scattered from the intended target. If more than one round is fired at that Aiming Point, or if the Aiming Point is on target, this scatter roll must be done.

Sheath Fire (Optional):

When an artillery battery is firing for effect, as opposed to firing ranging shots, it normally fires in a pattern called a 'Sheath'. To simulate this, after the Aiming Point is on target and the FO calls for 'fire for effect', each weapon in the battery will have a separate Aiming Point. No Aiming Point adjustment rolls will be done for these Aiming Points. The battery's Aiming Points will be in a pattern with the center Aiming Point (or the right center Aiming Point if there are an even number of guns in the battery) being the Aiming Point that was adjusted. These Aiming Points are spread out on a line with the distance between Aiming Points being one and one-half times the CZ radius. The direction of the line is parallel to the front of the battery. If the battery is off board, this direction must be set before the start of play.

The player can choose to fire all guns in the battery at a single Aiming Point.

FIELD ARTILLARY

<u>WEAPON</u>	<u>RANGE (in.)</u> Max./IDF Min.	<u>RATE OF FIRE</u> Rounds per turn	<u>RADIUS OF EFFECT</u>		
			NM	KZ	CZ
Lt. Mtr.	180/10	2	C	1"	2"
Mdm. Mtr.	320/10	1	C	1"	3"
Hvy. Mtr. (4.2")	500/75	1	1/2"	2"	4"
(120mm)	600/80	1	1/2"	2"	4"
75mm Pack How.	800/100	1	C	1"	3"
105mm How.	1150/120	1	1/2"	2"	4"
122mm How.	1280/250	1/2	1/2"	2"	4"
130mm Gun	2860/400	1/2	1/2"	2"	4"
152mm How.	1880/250	1/2	1"	3"	6"
155mm How.	1460/200	1/2	1"	3"	6"
175mm Gun	3270/400	1/4	1"	3"	8"
8" How.	1680/250	1/4	1"	4"	8"
NLF 3.5" RL*	400/100	Single Shot	1"	3"	8"
Soviet RL	1200/200	1/2 per tube	1/2"	2"	4"

NM=Near Miss, KZ=Kill Zone, CZ=Casualty Zone

*The NLF 3.5" RL (Rocket Launcher) is also known as "the flying pipe bomb". It is a large homemade rocket, about 8' long, with a simple non-reuseable launcher. It was normally employed as a direct fire weapon. In indirect fire (IDF) it can only use blind fire.

C means contact, i.e., only can get Near Miss from a miss on the Hits Due to Scatter or Indirect Fire Table.

SMOKE: Smoke from smoke and WP rounds cover the same area as the CZ of the round. (Smoke and WP Grenades use the same rules as smoke and WP shells.) Smoke moves in the direction of the wind. The distance it moves in inches is the wind strength (see weather rules). The duration of the smoke depends on the wind strength and a die roll. For each smoke cloud, roll a normal die each turn (after the first). A roll of less than the wind strength causes the smoke to dissipate (a roll of one always dissipates the smoke).

FLARES: Flares fired by artillery (or dropped by aircraft) are parachute flares. They last three turns and illuminate an area equal to three times the CZ radius of the weapon firing the flare. Flares move with the wind like smoke.

EXAMPLE:

Continuing our previous example, while the squad returns Luke's fire, the RTO (Radiotelephone operator) SP4 Blutz calls headquarters and requests an artillery or mortar fire mission. Since he is not a regular FO he is not in contact with the FDC and his request is relayed by the FO at headquarters (HQ).

The target he wishes to attack is the VC squad 286" away, which is still in the open, but is heading towards cover. He observed the squad last turn (while SSG McRed and the rest were firing) and now makes his call for fire.

It is the turn after Luke fired the RPG. (The U.S. return fire will take place in the cover fire phase, so it hasn't happened yet.) In phase 2, Sp4 Blutz contacts HQ (the player plots the desired indirect fire) and a 105mm Howitzer battery (six weapons) prepares to fire. Blutz gave coordinates for a point between the VC and the medium vegetation/rough ground they seem to be headed for. The cover is 16" away from the VC, and Blutz requests the fire halfway between them.

Blutz rolls two normal dice and gets a six. He needs a seven or better to get the right coordinates, he has no adjustments, so he made a mistake, and the round misses by so much he cannot see where it went. (He finds out he missed in phase seven.) The next turn he tries again, changing his aiming point to the patch of vegetation, since the VC have moved 8" closer to it. Now he rolls a nine on his two dice, so his aiming point is correct. Now in phase seven, we check where the round actually hits. (The VC continued toward the vegetation and entered it during the movement portion of the turn.) A twenty-sided die is rolled, giving thirteen. Checking the Indirect Fire Table, we see this misses, a sixteen was required, so the round scatters 2" to 40". Rolling a twenty-sided die, we get a six, so the round scatters 12". Checking direction with an eight-sided die (a six-sided die could be used if desired, but the player here prefers the eight-sider), it is specified that a one means north, a two northeast, a three east, etc. A five is rolled, so the round scatters to the south. We could check final wobble scatter now (step three in the indirect fire procedure), but since only one round was fired and it missed, we will not. (If more than one round had been fired, or if the round was a "hit", we would have to make the roll in step three. Also we had to specify whether or not we would do it before we did step two. We assume that these players are using the option not to use it in these circumstances.) On the next turn there is no need to repeat the FO roll, so we go directly to step two. A fourteen is rolled, which is less than sixteen, but since this is the second turn of fire, it receives a +3 adjustment which makes it a seventeen, so it hits. Now step three is completed. A normal die is rolled giving a three. This means the round scatters $3-1=2$ ". Rolling for direction as before, a one is rolled, so the round scatters 2" north of the aiming point. Now Blutz tells the artillery "on target, fire for effect". In the next turn the whole battery fires, in a normal sheath. The aiming points are put down 6" apart (105mm has a CZ of 4") parallel to the battery's front. Then a normal die is rolled for each round as before, the actual points hit are determined, and casualty rolls are done for anyone in the KZ or CZ of any round. We will handle only one of the six shells here. We will assume that it does not scatter (a one was rolled, $1-1=0$ scatter distance). The point it lands is 1" from one VC, 3" from another, and apparently right on a third. First we check to see if it actually hits the man direct or if this is a result of scale error. We roll a normal die and get a five. We see in the Hits Due to Scatter or Indirect Fire Table that a five or better is a direct hit, but there is an adjustment of -1 for object being man-sized, so $5-1=4$ means a near miss. Since the 105mm round is a near miss from the Table just mentioned, the VC is automatically a casualty (note d on the Casualties from HE Table). The second VC is in the KZ, while the third is in the CZ. Rolling a normal die for each, we get a two for the second and a five for the third. We see the second is not a casualty (he would be if he were standing) while the third is. The second is dazed, however, since he is in the KZ of an HE round. Getting slightly ahead of ourselves again, we will roll for casualty type for each of the two hit.

The first is in the KZ with a near miss. A two is rolled so he is KIA. He would only be WIA if it were not a near miss. The other VC (the third) is in the CZ, and a four is rolled. He is wounded. A normal die is rolled again and the wound table is consulted. A three is rolled so he is only lightly wounded. Now we would have to repeat these steps for each remaining shell, but since this is only an example, we will stop here.

WEAPON SET-UP TIMES (Turns):

<u>WEAPON</u>	<u>QUICK SET-UP</u>	<u>IDF SET-UP</u>
Medium Machine Gun (MMG)		
(MG with Tripod)	1/2#	
HMG (.50 cal, 14.5mm)	2/3#	
Wheeled mount MG	1/2	
57mm RR on tripod (no set-up time for shoulder fire)	1/2#	
75mm RR (Recoilless Rifle)	2/3##	
106mm RR	3/5##	
Light Mortar	1/2	3/6
Medium Mortar	2/3	4/7
Heavy Mortar	3/5	5/8
75mm Pack Howitzer	2/4	5/7
105mm Howitzer (How.)	3/5	6/8
122mm, 152mm, 155mm How.	4/6	7/10
130mm Gun	4/6	7/10
175mm Gun	30/36	30/36
8" Howitzer	30/36	30/36
NLF 3.5" Rocket Launcher	8/12	8/12
Soviet Rocket Launchers	2/4	7/10
Heavy Self-propelled Artillery (175mm and larger)	4/5	5/8
Smaller Self-propelled (SP) Artillery (including mortars)	1	3/6

#No set-up time if mounted on a vehicle

##No set-up time required if mounted on a vehicle, but weapon cannot move and fire in same turn.

The preceding table is arranged as follows: Quick Set-up Time is how long it takes to set up to fire at targets visible to the weapon's crew (direct fire or crew's own FO). IDF (Indirect Fire) Set-Up Time is how long it takes the crew to set up for IDF, i.e., get their exact position and set out azimuth stakes, etc., so that they can fire from directions given by the FDC. The number to the left of the slash is the time required for well-trained crews, that to the right of the slash is for poorer crews. (Western troops, ROK, ARVN elite, NVA, NLF cadre and Line, and Pathet Lao cadre count as well-trained.)

CASUALTIES FROM SHELLS (HE, WP, etc.):

For each figure within the CZ (or closer) of an exploding shell, roll one normal die, and consult the table below. (This just determines if a figure is a casualty, what type of casualty must still be determined.) For shell effects on vehicles and casualties of personnel in vehicles, see the vehicle section. Personnel riding on (outside) vehicles are rolled for on the table below.

SHELL CASUALTY TABLE:

<u>Figure is:</u>	<u>Within CZ</u>	<u>Within KZ</u>
Erect	3-6	Automatic
Prone	5-6	3-6
In Foxhole (with head up)	6	4-6
(also personnel in armored vehicles with head out hatch, etc.)		

Numbers are rolls that cause casualty. Personnel in foxhole with head down will not become casualties unless a direct hit occurs (direct hit with shell kills any figure) or there is a near miss from a 150mm or larger which will collapse the foxhole sides and causes an automatic casualty. All near misses cause automatic casualties to other troops. Near miss by 150mm or larger is automatically at least a serious wound, except to troops in foxholes with their heads down.

Grenades and Grenade Launchers:

Grenades are small time-fused bombs carried by infantrymen. There are four basic types of grenades used: fragmentation (frag), concussion, white phosphorus (Willy Peter), and smoke. The most commonly used grenade is the basis frag., with WP running a close second in jungle warfare. Concussion grenades are generally used when taking out bunkers, tunnels, or prepared positions. Smoke grenades come in several decorator colors and are primarily used to mark positions or to obscure them.

Grenades that are hand thrown have the following ranges, depending on the position of the thrower:

Prone	2"
Kneeling, crouching	3"
Standing erect	4"

To determine if a hit is made with a grenade, roll a six-sided die. A four or better hits, unless the target is behind an obstruction. If the target is behind a door, wall (6' high, no roof), or the like, a roll of five or six is needed to hit. If the target is a window, a six is needed to hit.

If the grenade missed, roll one six-sided die.

1,2	it lands 1" short
3	it lands 1" right
4	it lands 1" left
5,6	it lands 1" over

Note: a grenade cannot land over a target which is behind a window, door, etc. It bounces back.

Smoke grenades fill the circle of the CZ (WP also creates smoke with the same area), and the movement and duration of the smoke cloud is as described in the artillery section.

To determine casualties from grenades, roll a normal die for each figure in the CZ of all frag, concussion, and WP grenades, and consult the following table:

<u>figure is:</u>	<u>Grenade Casualty Table:</u>	
	<u>Die Roll in CZ</u>	<u>Die Roll in KZ</u>
erect	3-6	2-6
prone	5,6	4-6

Add +1 to the die roll if the figure is in an enclosed space.

For effects in tunnels, use the tunnel rules.

For M79 and M203 launcher grenades, subtract one from the die roll.

Frag grenades and WP grenades have: KZ = 1", CZ = 2".

Concussion and M79 grenades have: CZ = 1", no KZ.

Launched Grenades: Hit chances for launched grenades are as given in the small arms table. A direct hit with a launched grenade kills any figure.

Launched grenades (such as the M79 and M203) which miss their target have one-half chance to scatter 1", as shown above at short and medium range, otherwise they scatter 1" to 6" long over the target. At long or extreme range, misses scatter 1" to 3" in a random direction from the target.

Concussion grenades leave troops dazed for double the normal time, i.e., a six is needed on the recovery roll.



Hobo Woods Porcher
1967

Vehicle Descriptions:

M113 - Standard US and Allied Armored Personnel Carrier (APC) in Vietnam. An excellent vehicle which suffers from one drawback; it was designed to 'taxi' infantry into battle, with the troops dismounting and fighting on foot. US doctrine in the 1950's, when the M113 was designed, called for troops to dismount 200 meters away from the enemy, so the specifications for the M113 called for armor able to stop small arms fire at a range of 100 meters. At point blank range full power rifles (as opposed to SMG's) can penetrate the sides. Since troops fought mounted in Vietnam (often firing from the cargo hatch), this created a problem which led to a widely used modification with extra armor on the sides.

M113ACAV - The armored cavalry version of the M113, used by the divisional armored cavalry squadrons as well as the Black Horse Regiment. The ACAV had a cupola for the .50 cal. and two extra M50 MG's, plus, usually, a grenadier with an M79 firing from the top (cargo) hatch. Many of these had the heavier armor described above.

M114 - This light armored vehicle was designed as a replacement for the jeep in armored and recon units. It was deployed in Nam, but withdrawn due to problems with its mobility in that terrain. It was replaced in Nam with M113's and M113ACAV's.

M3 Halftrack - This WWII vehicle was used in Nam by ARVN. The version with one MG was an APC. A version with a quad .50, called the 'meat-chopper', was designed as an anti-aircraft weapon but was normally used against infantry.

M42 - The 'Duster' is a US anti-aircraft weapon which saw service in Nam. They were used for static defense by the Marines and for convoy escort by the Army. A Duster can do nasty things to a PT76.

M41 - The Walker Bulldog is a light tank which ARVN used as a medium or main battle tank, and the US sometimes used as a light tank. Although not a main battle tank, when equipped with the right ammo it can hold its own against T34's. In fact, in terrain where all tank battles are at close range (for tanks), the Bulldog can defeat T55's, and generally did in Nam.

M48 - This medium tank was the principal US tank in Nam. Although it was supposed to have been replaced by the M60, there were so many M48's available that the M60's, which were much in demand elsewhere (NATO), were rarely used in Nam. The M48 did an excellent job in South-east Asia.

M60 - The US main battle tank. Only limited numbers were sent to Nam, as described above. In Nam, the 105mm gun of the M60 was hardly more useful than the 90mm of the M48, but the M60's proved to be effective AFV's in Nam.

M551 - The 'Sheridan' is a combination armored recon vehicle and airborne assault gun which has never been particularly successful. It was used to a limited extent in Nam by the US. The Sheridans were supposed to replace M41's, but in Nam were themselves usually replaced by M48's. The Sheridan used the 152mm (6") Gun/Launcher which fires either a low velocity HEAT round or a Shillelagh Missile. Recoil when firing the HEAT round shakes the whole vehicle, and numerous problems were encountered with the missile. All told, it was not (and is not) a success. Although this vehicle is amphibious, the crew must leave the vehicle and erect the flotation sides before entering the water.

PT76 - This Russian light tank saw quite a bit of service with the NLF and the NVA in Nam, particularly during the Tet offensive. Its 76mm gun is low velocity making it badly outgunned when facing other armor, but it was effective against either militia (who often panicked) or positions without anti-tank weapons. Several times PT76's used to ambush convoys were wiped out by Dusters.

T34/85 - This WWII Russian tank was supplied to the NVA in large numbers. They were used in Cambodia and Laos by the Communists and were often seen across the DMZ by US troops, but were rarely used in South Vietnam.

T55 - This tank was used by the NVA in Nam. It was the standard main battle tank of the North Vietnamese. Before the US withdrawal, limited numbers of T55's were used in the South, but after the US withdrew T55's appeared widely. A contemporary of the M48, they should have been approximately matched, but the T55's usually lost when the encountered M48's.

Vehicle Table:

Type:	Main Weapon	Coax/Pintal	Movement Class	Crew ⁶	Notes
M113	.50 cal	-----	Fast Tracked	2(11)	APC, 1,5
M113ACAV	.50 cal	---/2 M60	Fast Tracked	5(6)	Note 5
M114	.50 cal	---/M60	Fast Tracked	3(1)	APC recon notes 2,5
M3 Half-track	.50 cal		Fast Tracked	2(10)	Some w/ quad .50
M8 Armored Car	37mm	.30/---	Lt wheeled 4-wh drive	3	
M42 Duster	2 - 40mm	---/.50 cal	Md Tracked	5	Open top turret
M41 Walker Bulldog	US 76mm	.30/.50	Fast Tracked	4	
M48	US 90mm	7.62/.50	Md Tracked	4	
M60	US 105mm	7.62/.50	Md Tracked	4	
M551 Sheridan	152 gun/launcher	7.62/.50	Fast Tracked	4	Missile not used in Nam. Note 4 Note 3
PT76	Sov. 76mm	7.62/7.62	Fast Tracked	3	
T34/85	Sov. 85mm	7.62/7.62	Md Tracked	4	
T55	Sov. 100mm	7.62/7.62	Md Tracked	4	

Notes:

- 1) Original version penetrated by small arms fire at short ranges. Later versions increased armor.
- 2) Cannot climb out of rice paddies, later replaced by M113.
- 3) Amphibious, MA in water = 10.
- 4) Amphibious with special sides (must be erected), water MA = 5.
- 5) Amphibious, MA in water = 5.
- 6) The number in parentheses is the passenger capacity.

Penetration of Heavy Weapons vs. Armor

US 76mm gun, 106mm RP, 90mm RR, and all 90mm and larger guns penetrate all armor.

85mm gun penetrates everything except turret front on M48 and M60. It will penetrate M48 turret front under 500mm, and has 1/2 chance otherwise.

57 and 75mm RR penetrate everything except: turret and front of hull of T34 or T55, and turret front and sides, and hull front of M48 and M60.

Soviet 76mm penetrates everything except turret fronts on M48 and M60. Has 1/2 chance to penetrate hull front of M48 and M60.

37mm and 40mm penetrate PT76, all APC's, all AC's, Sheridan hull, M42, and M41.

LAW penetrates PT76, M551, M41, M42, all APC's and the sides and rear of T34 and T55. It has 1/2 chance to penetrate everything else except the turret front of M48 and M60.

RPG and 3.5" Bazooka penetrate all except turret front of M48 and M60, and have 1/3 chance to penetrate them.

20-25mm will penetrate modified M113, M114, M8, M42 turret, Sheridan hull and PT76 hull to 100m. Will penetrate M3 and sides and rear of unmodified M113 at any range.

.50 cal-15mm will penetrate M3 and sides and rear of unmodified M113 to 500m. Will penetrate modified M113, front of M113, and sides and rear of Sheridan hull to 200m.

Full power small arms (those for which Flack Jackets provide no protection) have a 1/2 chance to penetrate sides and rear of unmodified M113 to 50m.

Vehicle Damage:

When a vehicle is hit, roll one normal die.

Against a turreted AFV:

1 = track, wheels or suspension hit

2,3,4 = hull hit

5,6 = turret hit

Against a non-turreted AFV:

2 - 6 = hull hit

A hull-down vehicle is only hit on a roll of five or six, otherwise, the cover in front of the vehicle is hit. An M113 or the like, with only its MG visible, is only hit on a roll of six.

Optional: T34, T55, and PT76 are only hit on a roll of 4 - 6 in a hull-down position, since they cannot depress their main guns as much as a Western tank.

If the weapon penetrates the armor, roll two six-sided dice and consult the following table.

Damage Roll (sum of two dice) Effect:	Vehicle Damage Table			
	4 or less None	5-8 Temp.	9-10 Perm.	11 plus Explodes

Adjustments to die roll:

For Damage:

For Casualties:

Weapon if:

LAW or 57mm RR	-2	-1
106mm RR, Gun/How. 90mm or larger	-2	+0
6" Gun/Lnchr, 152 Gun/How. plus	+4	+2
105mm or larger gun	+2	+1
37 and 40mm (hard/soft veh.)	-1/+4	+0
20 - 25mm (hard/soft veh.)	-2/+2	+0
.50 cal. - 15mm (hard/soft veh.)	-3/+1	-1
under .50 cal (hard/soft veh.)	-4/-1	-1

Use this vehicle damage roll (as an APV) for soft vehicles hit by 40mm and smaller. In this case there is no need to check for penetration.

Note: An unmodified roll of twelve (sum of two dice) is always an explosion, while an unmodified roll of two is always No Effect.

Damage Effects:

Explodes; vehicle is destroyed, add +1 to the casualty roll.

Permanent Damage; section of vehicle is knocked out. If hull knocked out, vehicle cannot move. If turret out, vehicle cannot fire any turret guns.

Temporary Damage; section of vehicle hit is knocked out until repaired. Repair can be done by a trained crew. On the second turn that they are working on it, and every succeeding turn until the repair is successful, roll a six-sided die. A roll of six means the repair is completed.

Track, etc.; No movement is possible, vehicle will not explode.

Casualty Roll: A roll of five or six is a casualty. Except when the vehicle explodes, only those personnel in the section which is hit can become casualties.

Shells vs. Vehicles and Heavy Weapons:

Note: This applies to non anti-tank rounds.

Soft Vehicles and Heavy Weapons:

	Destroy:	Disable:
KZ	1,2,3	4,5,6
CZ	1,2	3,4

Note: Direct hits always destroy if larger than 40mm.

Note: Disabled heavy weapons have flat tires and aiming gear is destroyed.

If the vehicle is not destroyed, the passengers take casualties as though they were prone. If the vehicle is destroyed, the passengers take casualties as though standing.

Hard Vehicles: HE and WP have no effect on hardened vehicles unless a direct hit or near miss occurs. Rounds which fall inside an AFV (open-topped) result in automatic destruction.

Hardened Vehicles:

Shell	Direct Hit:		Near Miss:		Size of Near Miss
	Destr.	Disable	Destr.	Disable	
Lt. Mortar	Must enter vehicle				
75mm pack How.	1	2,3	---	---	---
medium mortar*					
Sov. R.L.,	1,2,3	4,5	---	1,2	1/2"
Hvy Mortar,					
105,122,130*					
152,155,175	1 - 5	6	1,2	3,4,5	1"
8",3.5" rocket	1 - 6	---	1,2,3	4,5,6	1"

*Indirect fire only (plunging fire on hull deck and turret top).

Note: WP will either destroy or have no effect. Cannot disable.

EXAMPLE:

Shifting to another unit for this example, B troop, an ACAV unit, is conducting a sweep in northwest South Vietnam. First platoon has two M48 tanks and five M113 ACAV's. They run into an NVA platoon of two T55's. The range is 125" (1-1/4 km) and the NVA spot the ACAV first, since the NVA are stationary and the ACAV are moving. The ACAV will not see the T55's until they get within 75" of them (both groups are in open terrain) while the NVA saw the ACAV as soon as there was a clear line of sight, which we will assume was at a range of 155" when the ACAV came over a hill. That was at the beginning of this turn, the ACAV moved 30" (open hard ground) and the 125" range is at the end of movement.

The T55's open fire in the cover fire portion of the turn. They could wait until the ACAV is closer, but they are afraid that the M113's will stop and then they will be seen, since the ACAV will also count as stationary observers. The range is half the maximum, so it counts as medium (we assume it is just under rather than just over 125"). The To Hit Number for a Soviet 100mm gun at 125" is 10. The adjustments to the die roll will be: target moving more than 20" -4, target vehicle +0, NVA tank crew at medium range -3, total -7. The T55's each fire at one of the M48's, since they are more dangerous to the tanks than the M113 ACAV's are. The first T55 rolls a fifteen, the second rolls a thirteen, so both miss when we subtract seven from them. Since heavy weapons cannot fire in both the cover and regular fire phases, that is it for the NVA this turn. The M48's return fire in the regular fire portion of the turn (they spotted the T55's when they fired). The To Hit Number of a U.S. 90mm gun at 125" is six. The adjustments are: attacker moving more than 10" -8, AFV under fire that can damage it -1, vehicle size target +0, target visible for less than 1/2 turn -2, and Western Crew +0, total -11. The rolls are six and twenty, so the latter is a hit. The T55's are hull down. The roll to see where the tank was hit is a two, so the shell hits the cover in front of the tank.

We have not checked the scatter for either side yet. They are all shooting at medium range. We also have not yet taken a morale check for the ACAV. Since the NVA fired before they were seen, it counts as a surprise attack. We should have taken the morale check before the ACAV returned fire, but here the gamemaster know the ACAV will be able to fire even if they roll a two (which would require them to withdraw, but they could still fire as they did) he let them fire first.

Checking scatter, there is a 1/2 chance (four to six on one die) that the round will scatter 1-3" in a random direction, otherwise it will scatter 1-20" long. We roll five and three for the T55's, so one T55's round scatters 1-20" long, and we roll a nine. The other T55's round scatters 1-3", we roll a normal die, get five, divide by two, so the round scatters 3". For direction, we roll an eight-sided die (again, we could have used a six-sided one) and get a six, so if our base direction is north, the shell scatters 3" west. The first round doesn't come near anything, but assume the second seems to hit a M113. Using the Hits Due to Scatter and Indirect Fire Table we roll a three, so this is really a miss, it just looks like a hit due to our scale distortion. The 100mm shell counts as a 105mm howitzer shell (actually, it is less powerful, but we fudged it for playability) and will not effect the APC on a near miss, so the ACAV have taken no losses.

Checking the ACAV's morale, there are no adjustments, so they use whatever they roll. Their two-die roll is a seven, so their morale is O.K.

Now, after the morale check, the M48's return fire (which we have already rolled for). Checking their scatter, the round that misses gets a two so it scatters 1-20" long, we roll a fourteen and it misses everything.

In the next turn, the M113's head for a nearby hill trying to get behind it since they have no weapon that will hurt the T55's. They do fire with their .50 cal HMG's just in case there are any crew members standing in open hatches or the like, but there aren't, so we will ignore this. The platoon's FO is trying to call for artillery while they are moving, but this will take a while. Since he saw them (the T55's)

last turn and did nothing else besides move, he had an action free to observe them, and he did, so he can call for fire (plot it) this turn. He requests fire from as heavy artillery as is available at a point midway between the two T55's (they are 6" apart). We will see what happens to that at the end of this turn. The M48's remain stationary and fire as rapidly as they can, that is in the cover fire phase. The T55's do the same.

Checking the NVA first, the To Hit Number is still ten, adjustments are: NVA crew at medium range -3, AFV under fire that can effect it -1, second shot +1, total -3. They roll a nine and a sixteen, so the latter is a hit. The other scatters as before, and we find it scatters nowhere near anything. The M48's To Hit Number is six, their adjustments are: +1 for second shot, -1 for being under fire, total +0. They roll an eleven and a five, so the former hits. Checking scatter on the other, it is not near anything. Since the T55 is hull down, it may still be all right. The M48 roll a die to see where the T55 is hit and a six is rolled, which is the turret, so it is a hit. The T55 rolls a three, so the M48 is hit in the hull. We see that both weapons will penetrate the other's armor. Rolling damage, the U.S. player rolls an eight, which is adjusted up to a nine for the weapon size, so the T55 has its turret permanently damaged. Rolling for casualties, we must check every one in the turret (three men, commander, loader, and gunner) so we roll three dice. A five, a four, and a one are rolled, so the commander is the only casualty. Checking type, a four is rolled, so he is wounded, and a five is rolled, so it is a light wound. Now we check their morale. The crew must make two morale checks, one for being in a damaged vehicle and one for their 25% casualties. The adjustments are: -1 for the 25% casualties and -1 for being in a damaged vehicle, total -2. The rolls are eight and six, which become six and four. The unit (crew) would refuse to advance, but is otherwise OK. Following the same procedure for the T55's hit, we roll a five which becomes a six, so the M48 has temporary damage to the hull and cannot move until it is fixed. Checking casualties, only the driver can be hurt, a six is rolled, so he is. It turns out to be a light wound. The M48 crew must now make two morale checks, at the same -2 as the NVA had. A ten and a seven are rolled, and the effects are the same as on the NVA.

Now the artillery comes down. One ranging shell was fired by a 155mm Howitzer. The FO roll (two normal dice) is a ten, so it is good. (The adjustments were specially trained FO, +3, on moving vehicle -2, total +1.) Rolling for the ranging round on the indirect fire to hit table, we get a twenty, so the FDC got the aiming point right. Checking scatter (we must do this because it is on the aiming point), we roll a die and get a one, 1-1=0, so there is no scatter. The round is 3" from each T55, so they are both just in the CZ, but there is no effect on an armored vehicle from this.

The battle would continue until one side withdraws or is destroyed. In this case, the NVA withdraws on the next turn before the 155's come in. The M48's get to fire at them in the cover fire phase as they leave, with the penalty adjustment of -2 for target visible for less than 1/2 turn. Both M48's fire at the undamaged T55. One gets a +2 bonus for third shot, the other has changed targets and gets no subsequent shot bonus. The first has an adjustment of -4 for target moving fast, -2 for less than 1/2 turn in sight, +2 for third shot, total -4. The second's adjustment is -6. The first rolls a sixteen and the second a nineteen, so both seem to hit, but we check and only the first hits the turret (roll of five on a normal die), the other hits the tracks (roll of one) which are not visible, so one round hits the cover as the tank leaves. The hit penetrates. We roll two dice for a seven which becomes an eight, so the T55 has temporary turret damage (it will be able to fire again after it fixes it). Rolling for casualties we get one, the loader, who is seriously wounded. We should check the NVA's morale again, even though they are leaving. A twelve is rolled so we know it is OK without checking the adjustments.

The artillery will still come down since it is too late to stop it, but we won't bother to roll exactly where since there is nothing that can be hit. The M48 crew will now try to repair their vehicle. They can only roll a repair die every other turn, so it will be one more turn before they can roll. Naturally this counts as an action, in fact, the men working on repair cannot do anything else that turn, and they must be in the right compartment, or outside working on it. The turret crew can move down to try and help the driver next turn. On the same turn he will be able to make his first roll, he will need a six to repair the vehicle.

Effect of Casualties:

To determine the type of casualty suffered by a figure, roll a six-sided die and consult the following table:

<u>Casualty Type Table:</u>		
<u>Weapon:</u>	<u>KIA</u>	<u>WIA</u>
Small Arms	1	2 or better
HE Shell, Frag or Concussion Grenade	1	2 or better
Near Miss with HE Shell	1,2	3 or better
WP, Flechette, Strafing, Puff, or Minigun	1,2	3 or better
Napalm	See p. 38	
Claymore	1,2	3 or better
Crew of penetrated AFV	1,2	3 or better
Near Miss with WP	1-4	5 or better
If a figure is WIA, roll a normal (six-sided) die and consult the following table:		

<u>Wound Type:</u>		
	<u>Serious</u>	<u>Light</u>
HE Shell in KZ, Small Arms	1-3	4-6
Strafing, Puff or Minigun	1-4	5,6
HE in CZ (incl. grenade)	1,2	3-6
Concussion grenade	1	2-6
WP, Claymore, Flechette	1-4	5,6
Napalm	See p. 38	
Near Miss w/HE or WP	1-6	
Crew of penetrated AFV*	1-3	4-6

*Flack vest offers regular protection if penetration was by HE, HEAT, or HEP.

Effects of Wounds:

Light wounds cause loss of two MA per wound, and the combat minuses in the tables.

Serious wounds cause helplessness, can only crawl, and no combat is possible.

Four light wounds = one serious wound

Two serious wounds = coma

Three serious wounds = KIA

Effect of Flack Vests:

Flack Jackets can save the life of the wearer. When a man wearing a flack vest is hit by a low power round (see Small Arms Table), or is within the KZ or CZ of an HE blast from artillery, mortar, grenade, mine, etc., (but not a concussion grenade) add +1 to the wound die roll. An adjusted roll of seven means NO EFFECT. (The round or fragment was stopped by the vest.)

A Flack vest also helps in hand-to-hand combat, as detailed under those rules.

Only the allied side wore Flack Jackets. Some units always wore them, others never did. US Mech units, Armor Crews, and Combat Engineers were likely to use them. Aircrews (helicopters) had them, but some didn't like them. Most probably wore them, however. Airmobile troops often sat on theirs in the copters. Use of them will have to be up to the gamemaster or players.

Medics and First Aid:

Only seriously wounded troops will require treatment during the game.

Seriously wounded figures have 1/3 chance of falling unconscious each turn starting six turns after they are wounded. If unconscious, they have 1/6 chance of dying each turn. Seriously wounded figures who are not unconscious may cry out for aid, thereby giving away their positions. Their chances of doing so depends on their morale class (see p. 28) After a number of turns (N, see table below), even if they are dazed.

<u>Number of Turns After Which Wounded May Cry Out</u>				
<u>Class:</u>	<u>A</u>	<u>B</u>	<u>C</u>	<u>D</u>
<u>N Turns:</u>	<u>6</u>	<u>4</u>	<u>3</u>	<u>2</u>

First Aid Kits: Seriously wounded personnel with first aid kits have 1/3 chance of treating themselves. Anyone with a first aid kit can give first aid to wounded personnel (seriously wounded figures must have treated themselves before they can treat others). Treatment by non-medics requires three full turns. Medics can treat wounded in one full turn.

Western, ROK, and ARVN troops are supposed to have two medics attached to each platoon and all personnel are supposed to have first aid kits. One medic per platoon was more common. Unfortunately, ARVN troops, except for elites, tended to sell their first aid kits. There is a 1/6 chance of an ARVN trooper, other than a medic, having a first aid kit. ARVN elite troops, other than medics, had a 5/6 chance for each man to have a first aid kit.

The NVA and NLF cadre units usually had first aid kits, either captured or purchased on the black market. Each figure has a 5/6 chance to have a first aid kit. NLF line units have a 5/6 chance that there will be a first aid kit in each squad.

Cambodian government troops were the same as ARVN. Pathet Lao and Khmère Rouge were the same as NLF line.

Mercenary and irregular troops, such as Nungs, Montagniards, and militia (of both sides) carried no first aid kits, and depended on their organizers or advisors for first aid.

Seriously wounded troops that have been treated will not cry out or fall unconscious, but otherwise remain seriously wounded with all the associated limitations.

EXAMPLE:

Our friends from Alpha Company are now moving in their APC down a dirt road. Luke the Gook has moved over to the same road (we assume the rest of the fire the squad sent his way in an earlier example missed him and he crawled away) and is waiting with his RPG. Luke fires at a range of 7" (70m) and rolls a nine. The APC is moving rapidly (over 20" per turn) and Luke has a light wound, so the adjusted die roll is 9-4-1=4. Looking at the Heavy Weapons Hit Table, we see an RPG needs a three or better at this range, so the APC is hit. A roll of three on a normal die determines that it hits the vehicle body. The RPG will penetrate any APC (the squad is in a M113) so we proceed to the vehicle damage table. Luke rolls two normal dice and gets a four, so the APC is not damaged. (Lucky!) We still have to check for casualties, however. There are nine men in the vehicle, so we roll nine normal dice, any fives or sixes are casualties. There are three casualties. Rolling randomly to determine who they are, we find Pvt. Turket, Pfc Williams, and Sp4 Green are hit. Rolling for casualty type, we get rolls of two, three, and four, so Turket is KIA and the other two are wounded, but the squad is wearing Flack Jackets, which may save it. Rolling for wound type, we get a six and a two which become a seven and a three with the Flack Jacket Adjustment. The seven means no effect, so Williams' Flack Vest has saved him. Sp4 Green is seriously wounded.

The squad must make a morale check because it is in a penetrated armored vehicle, and another because it has been attacked by surprise. It has only taken two casualties out of nine men (remember Williams was saved by his Flack Vest!), so that is less than 25%. Two normal dice are rolled for each morale check, and a six and a ten are rolled. The adjustments are: +0, since they are class B troops (U.S. Regulars), unit in a penetrated vehicle do not get cover bonus (it was penetrated after all) but the vehicle is undamaged, so no minus. The roll of ten has no effect, but the roll of six means the squad will not advance toward the enemy. They do return fire and can roll each succeeding turn until they get an adjusted roll of seven or better, at which time their morale is OK again. We will assume that they head for home to get Green to a medic. They give him first aid on the way.

Morale:

Units (patrols, squads, or larger) must check morale in the following situations:

- 1) A green unit or any militia unit which takes its first casualties in an action.
- 2) The unit has suffered 25%, 50%, or 75% casualties.
- 3) The unit is surrounded and knows it, and know that it is surrounded by more than just a single sniper, etc.
- 4) The unit is overrun.
- 5) The unit is in a damaged vehicle, or a penetrated armored vehicle.
- 6) The unit attempts an heroic or suicidal act.
- 7) Infantry who have taken casualties from an air attack.
- 8) The unit is attacked from the rear.
- 10) The unit is attacked by surprise
- 11) The unit has lost its leader(s) (no NCO's or officers left).
- 12) The unit is short of ammo and in a firefight (short of ammo means less than 25% of the normal amount).
- 13) The unit has retreated for four consecutive turns.
- 14) The unit is infantry in the open attacked by armor.
- 15) A friendly unit routs in sight (unless the routing unit is dispised by the observing unit.).
- 16) The unit is Class C or D troops under effective fire (i.e., 1/2 or more of the unit is pinned) for six or more turns.
- 17) Pinned troops who attempt to advance.
- 18) Class C or D troops who attempt to advance into enemy fire.
- 19) Militia or any other Class D troops attacked by armor.

To conduct a morale check, the player rolls two normal dice and totals the result. If the result is:

7 or better - the unit is OK, reforms if routed, may reenter abandoned vehicles, etc.

4 - 6 - The unit refuses to leave cover, goes to cover (or prone if no cover with 1/2 move distance except in the direction of the enemy), vehicles refuse to advance. The unit may fire, or retreat if desired. Personnel will remain in disabled vehicles.

2 or 3 - The unit retreats, evacuates disabled vehicles if possible, and may fire as it withdraws.

Less than 2 - The unit routs, flees or surrender if unable to flee. It abandons disabled vehicles and heavy weapons. Crew will flee from damaged vehicles.

If a unit's morale fails, check each turn thereafter until it either rallies or routs off the board. If a unit routs off the board, it cannot return.

Die roll adjustments:

Green troops	-1
Class A troops	+2
Class C troops	-1
Class D troops	-2
Unit has cover (does not apply if unit is attempting to leave the cover)	+2
Leader is out of action	-1
Unit has 25% casualties	-1
Unit has 50% casualties	-3
Unit has 75% casualties	-4
Unit is a damaged vehicle (cannot receive cover bonus)	-1
Unit is surrounded or overrun	-2
Unit is militia defending its home	+2
Militia under attack by armor	-2
Unit is attempting suicidal act (no minus for merely heroic one)	-3
Unit has fire superiority	+2
Enemy had fire superiority	-2
NVA in penetrated AFV	-2

Morale TableClass A

U.S. Elite
NLF cadre
Nungs

Class B

U.S. Regulars
ARVN Elite
NVA Regulars
NLF Regulars
ROK Regulars
Khmere Rouge
Pathet Lao cadre
Australasian Regulars
New Zealander Regulars
Montagniards, Meos

Class C

U.S. Draftees (green)
ARVN Regulars
NLF local forces
Pathet Lao Regulars
Cambodian Government troops
Royal Laotian Government troops

Class D

ARVN local forces ("strikers")
Pathet Lao local forces

Class A: Very high morale, well led, well trained, fanatics or career troops.

Class B: Good morale, professional troops.

Class C: Fair morale, usually good soldiers but not capable of protracted heroics.

Class D: Poor morale, will fight well only if there is no other alternative.



MONSOON SEASON
IN TAY NINH - 1969

EXAMPLE:

Our friends in Alpha Company have left the hill and are advancing on foot toward a wooded area several clicks away from their previous position. The APC is covering them from several hundred meters back.

As the point man, Sp4 Ebar, approaches within 100mm (10") of the woods, he is fired on by a VC with a Type 50 SMG. It is in the cover fire portion of the turn. The VC player rolls a ten; his adjustments are: target walking -1, long range (he misjudged it) -4, marksman Class D at long range -1, autofire at single target +6, total +0, therefore Ebar is hit. (The VC fired at him alone because he couldn't get anyone else within the zone of fire at the same time.) Rolling for number of hits, we roll a one, so Ebar is only hit once. Ebar is wearing a Flack Jacket, and a SMG round may be stopped by one. Rolling for casualty type, we get a four, WIA; and rolling for wound type we get a 6+1 (+1 is Flack Jacket adjustment) which is a 7, or no effect. (The round was stopped by the Flack Jacket.) Ebar immediately goes prone and throws a smoke grenade between himself and the VC, while his buddies and the APC fire at the VC. Ebar is pinned. We will assume that the squad does not hit the VC with its fire, but it does pin him. Now let's check the effect of the smoke grenade. There is a strength two wind from the west, and Ebar is due south of the VC. Since he falls prone and then throws the grenade, he can only throw it 2". He tries to throw it 2" due north. Rolling a normal die, we get a 3, which is less than 4 so the round scatters 1". Rolling a die again we get a 4, which means the grenade scatters left (west). It goes off at the end of the turn (phase 7) and the smoke covers an area of 4" diameter, with Sp4 Ebar just on the edge of it. In the next turn more fire is exchanged (we assume no one was hit) and the wind dissipates the smoke. A roll of less than the wind strength is required to dissipate the smoke, and a three is rolled so the smoke remains. Ebar has been covered by the smoke all turn, and the VC does not fire into the smoke since he has other members of the squad that he can see firing at him. Before Sp4 Ebar advances he has to make a morale check, because it counts as a heroic action. The squad has fire superiority so Ebar gets +2, and there is no adjustment for troop morale class because a U.S. Regular (morale class B) is +0. Ebar rolls two normal dice and gets a seven, so his adjusted roll is a nine, and he can advance. Ebar gets up, moves forward through the smoke and goes prone again on the edge of the woods (inside them) about 2" east of the VC. This calls for a move of 10-1/2" (movement cost of 10-1/2 since terrain is open, hard ground) and Ebar is only covered by the smoke for the first 4", so the VC can fire at him in the later portion of the turn, but it still counts as cover fire. The VC fires at close range and rolls a six. His adjustments are: target running -3, autofire at one target +6, target visible for more than 1/2 turn -1, firer pinned -5, total -3, so he misses, and Ebar makes it to the woods. At this point the VC has fired five bursts for a total of thirty rounds. He fires his last rounds in that magazine in a burst at Ebar, since he knows that Ebar will attack him next turn. Now his adjustments are: target prone with cover (Ebar is prone behind a tree) -5, in light vegetation -1, firer pinned -5, autofire +6, total -5. A ten is rolled, which is a miss, but Ebar is pinned again. In the next turn the VC spends his first action reloading, while Ebar throws a frag grenade. Ebar rolls a five for his grenade throw, so his grenade lands where he wants it (or within a few feet of it, which is the same thing here) and the VC is in the KZ. Rolling for casualty a six is rolled, and the VC is hurt. He is also dazed since he is in the KZ, but it does not matter since we roll a one on the casualty type and he is KIA.

Since the frag grenade has a CZ of 2" and Ebar could only throw the grenade 2" from a prone position, he is within the CZ. Rolling for him we get a three, so he is OK, although he would have been a casualty if he wasn't prone.

Checking Ebar's condition, he was walking for one turn, running for one turn, and in a fire fight for four turns, so he has expended $1+10+4 \times 3 = 23$ fatigue points.

Pungi Sticks and Mines:

Pungi Sticks are sharpened slivers of bamboo, usually steeped in rancid excrement before placement. They are planted in shallow holes or ditches, then covered with leaves or other innocent looking debris to wait patiently for some unsuspecting person to step in and impale his leg or foot. This usually results in immediate immobilization for the casualty, and should be treated as a serious wound.

The player(s) using pungi stick patches (usually the defender) indicates his location on a sketch map that is given to the gamemaster. If any figure on foot enters an area shown on the map to be infested with Pungi, the gamemaster secretly rolls a normal die and consults the following chart:

<u>Pungi Casualty Table:</u>	
<u>Pungi Density:</u>	<u>Roll for Casualty:</u>
Low	1
Medium	1,2
High	1,2,3

Pungi sticks can be planted in low, medium or high density. A soldier can set out 4" x 4" of low density, 2" x 2" of medium density, or 1" x 1" of high density pungi every fifteen turns.

Mines: Land mines are divided into two basic types; anti-personnel and anti-vehicle (AT). A vehicle of any type will set off both kinds of mines, while a person on foot will set off only the anti-personnel type.

Mine locations are handled the same way as pungi stick patches. The gamemaster is given a sketch map marked with a 1" x 1" area for each mine location (one mine). (Note: The anti-personnel mines used



are all trip-wire triggered.) Unlike punji sticks, once a mine is detonated it is no longer there.

If a person on foot enters an anti-personnel mine area, the game-master secretly rolls a normal die. A roll of four, five, or six detonates a mine. Anti-personnel mine detonations are equivalent to a medium mortar round, and cause casualties accordingly.

Vehicles moving through anti-personnel patches detonate them automatically with the same blast effect.

AT Mines: Vehicles detonate AT mines on a roll of six with a normal die. Soft vehicles are destroyed automatically.

Mine Effects on AFV's:	
Immobilize	Penetrate
1,2,3	4,5,6

If the vehicle is penetrated, use the normal damage rules to determine the effect.

If an AFV is penetrated by an AT mine, members of its crew can become casualties.

When an AT mine detonates, troops near the point of detonation take casualties as from a light mortar blast.

Note: A command detonated AT mine can be placed on a road or other area vehicles move through and have the same damage effect as regular AT mines.

Mine Placement: One man can place a mine in three turns.

Clearing: Anti-personnel mines or punji sticks can be discovered by troops moving cautiously in search of them. They move 1" per turn, creeping on all fours or crouching with a Fatigue Point cost as for crawling. Punji sticks are always discovered successfully. If a searching figure enters an anti-personnel mine area, there is a 1/6 chance he will detonate the mine, otherwise the mine is found safely.

A discovered mine can be marked in one turn so it can be avoided. Only Engineering troops ('sappers') can disarm mines. Each sapper requires one full turn to disarm one mine.

Searching for AT mines is more difficult, the ground must be probed. The searcher can move at 1/2" per turn, with the same fatigue cost as for crawling. All mines and punji sticks are found safely when searching this way.

Engineer troops using mine detectors will detect all mines, but will not find punji sticks. They move at 1" per turn.

Hand-to-Hand Combat:

When two (or more) opposing troops get within 1/2" of each other they may enter into hand-to-hand combat. Each player rolls one normal (six-sided) die, then adds and subtracts the adjustments from the table below. The man with the higher adjusted number wins. Ties continue fighting next turn.)

If the winner's adjusted score is one better than his opponent's, the loser takes one light wound and combat continues on the next turn. If it is two better, the loser takes a serious wound and if it is three better, the loser is killed. Optionally, if prisoners are desired, by stating so before the roll, an adjusted roll of three or more greater than the enemy's will capture him, but in this case, a roll of one or two better has no effect.

If both men wish to retreat, combat is automatically broken off. If only one wants to retreat, and the other wishes to continue, the figure wishing to withdraw must say so before the roll and then must beat his opponent's adjusted roll or he will be attacked from the rear as he leaves.

If two men are fighting against one man, there shall be a separate roll for each figure, but neither of the two allied figures can be injured unless the single man beat both of his opponents' adjusted rolls. In this case, only the opposing figure with the lowest adjusted die roll is injured, and his wound is determined by his partner's adjusted roll. Combats of more than two on one are handled similarly.

Effect of Flack Jackets on hand-to-hand combat: If a figure wearing a Flack Jacket loses a roll, subtract a one from the difference between the two adjusted rolls before determining the loser's wound status. A Flack Jacket can reduce the wounds received, but it cannot increase combat effectiveness.

Note: When in hand-to-hand combat, the only actions allowed are dropping object in hands, drawing weapon, or attempting to disengage from combat, moving after disengagement, and attempt to fire weapon at opponent (see To Hit Table).

HAND-TO-HAND COMBAT ADJUSTMENTS

Morale Class A	+2
Morale Class B	+1
Morale Class D	-1
US, Australians or New Zealanders	+2
POK (in Viet Nam)	+2
Light Wound	-2/wound
Kneeling	-1
Prone	-3
In Foxhole	-3
Attacked from Rear	-3
Surprised	-2
Has in hands*: rifle, carbine, etc.	+1
Bayoneted rifle, et	+3
Knife, entrenching tool	+2
Machete	+3
Cumbersome object (e.g., mortar tube or tripod)	-2
Fatigued (less than 1/5 Base Fatigue Point Allowance left)	-2
Exhausted	-3
Drawing weapon in melee	-2
Attempting to fire weapon in melee (gets no benefit for weapon)	-2

*If attacked from rear, can only receive cumbersome object adjustment.

EXAMPLE:

We rejoin SSG McRed and his boys the next day. They are searching a village. PFC Williams enters a hut from one side just as an NVA enters the other side. They are in hand-to-hand combat range (less than 1/2") and have at it. Each rolls a normal die, Williams gets a three and Nygun Minh (the VC) rolls a five. Williams get a one for being morale class B, +2 as a Westerner (larger than the locals), and a +1 for his rifle, so his adjusted total is seven. Minh gets a +1 for his morale class (he is a VC regular) and +2 for his rifle (AK47) so his adjusted total is seven also. There is no effect, so the two men continue the fight in the next turn. In the next turn, Williams rolls a two and gets a total of six; Minh rolls a five and gets a total of seven again. Since Minh has the higher total, he wins this round and Williams should receive a light wound. However, Williams is still wearing his Flack Vest, so Minh's plus one advantage is reduced by one to zero, and Williams is OK. His Flack Vest saved him again. On the next round, Williams gets angry and rolls a six, getting a total of ten, so Minh is a gone goose. He rolls a six also, but his total is only eight so he is two down and takes a serious wound. Minh is now helpless (since he has a serious wound, he can only crawl) and Williams captures him.

Checking on Williams' status, he was fighting hand-to-hand for three turns, while wearing a Flack Vest. He used up seventy-five fatigue points. This is as much as walking for fifty minutes (seventy-five turns). As a U.S. Regular, he only had one hundred twenty FP to begin with. Assuming that he had been trotting for four turns and walking for twenty more before he fought Minh, he now has $120 - 20 - 4(3) - 75 = 13$. This is below 1/5 of his base of 120, so Williams is tired (fatigued). If the combat had lasted another turn, he would have had a -2 adjustment for that.

Static Defenses:

Static defenses were an integral part of the Allied tactics and strategy in the Vietnam conflict. At one point it was carried to the obvious, absurd conclusion and gave birth to the 'McNamara Line' near the DMZ. Besides battery operated electronic detection devices, there were mutually supporting fire bases with interlocking fields of fire, heavily defended forward observation posts, and huge forward supply bases. There were also other fortified positions in Vietnam, such as Special Forces camps, and forward operating bases. These were more or less on the level, and had the same appearance as Fort Apache - with barbed wire. Anyone who has seen the movie, "The Green Berets", will have a pretty good idea of what they look like. As this frontier cavalry post concept was the most common, a diagram of a typical post, intended to be defended by a force anywhere from a minimum of company strength to a maximum of battalion strength, has been included. Barbed wire, claymores, trip flares, and mines were commonly used in the defenses of these posts.

Claymore mines were one of the standard means of perimeter defense (both temporary and static) in Vietnam. Claymores are wire command detonated, aimed casualty zone mines. (They can also be detonated by trip wire; treat as an anti-personnel mine with special KZ and CZ.) They explode in the direction that you have them pointed. The Kill Zone (KZ) is a one inch radius circle around the mine, plus a cone 10" long which is 2" wide near the mine and expands to a width of 10" at the far end. The CZ is a continuation of this cone out to 20" plus a 2" radius circle around the mine. Note: The command detonated claymore can be disarmed (by cutting the wire) or rearmed by anyone who finds it.

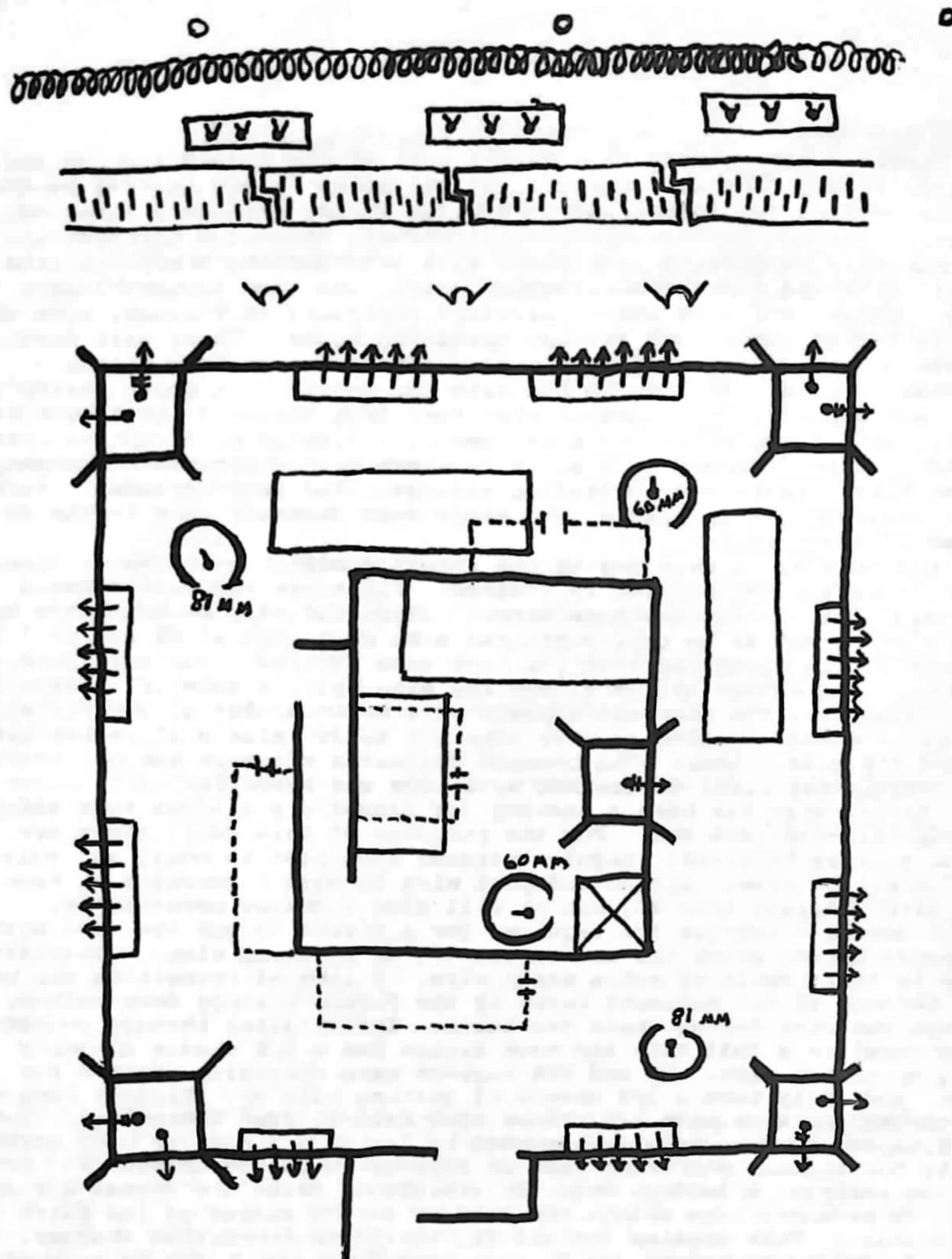
Barbed wire has been a standby for prepared positions ever since the Spanish-American War. For the purposes of this game, there are two kinds of wire barriers: regular strands from post to post, and rolls of Concertina wire. Strand and post wire is more successful at keeping out water buffalo than VC, but it will slow a charge momentarily. Eight movement factors are required for a figure to cut the wire with clippers during which the figure can not do anything else. Concertina wire is large coils of extra nasty wire. A line of concertina can be cut through in two movement turns if the figure cutting does nothing except cut wire during those two turns. Infiltrating through concertina requires a full turn and each figure has a 5/6 chance of being hung up on the wire. VC and NVA sappers were specially trained for this, and only have a 1/2 chance of getting hung up. Figures hung up on concertina wire have 1/6 chance each turn to free themselves. Concertina can be successfully breached by laying a ladder or door across, or by blowing out a section with HE fire or bangalore torpedoes. Note: anyone carrying a ladder, etc., is visible at twice the normal distance.

HE breaches wire within one-half of the KZ radius of its point of detonation. This applies for all HE, shells or demolition charges.

Bangalore Torpedoes are 3' long pipe bombs which can be screwed together end to end. They are pushed under barbed wire or into minefields on the ends of long poles, then detonated. They clear a two inch wide gap the length of the bangalore. An Engineer can assemble a bangalore at the rate of one section per turn. Anyone can use a single section of bangalore. When a bangalore explodes, each section has the effect of a heavy mortar shell. Note: A bangalore will detonate if it is within the KZ of an HE burst, or within the area of a frag or concussion grenade.

Demolition charges are large charges of HE with time delay fuses. They are primarily used to destroy bunkers and buildings. The detonation of a demolition charge has the effect of an HE burst with a KZ of 2", and a concussion grenade with a CZ of 4". The charge is placed (not thrown) and is set for a time delay of one to three turns. They will breach any wall (of reasonable thickness) they are placed against and effect whatever is on the other side. (Note: six foot thick concrete walls were not found in Nam, any wall encountered can be assumed to be of a reasonable thickness.)

Trip flares are small flares mounted on trees or poles which are set off by trip wires like a mine. They were widely used in static and temporary defenses to provide warning of attack. Each trip flare illuminates a 3" radius area for two turns. Treat them as mines for location and disarming.



FORWARD OPERATING BASE

NOTE: barbed wire, mines, etc. extend completely around camp, four or more belts.

○ Trip Flare	◻ Bunker	◻ Building
W Claymore	— Sandbag Wall	◻ Watch Tower
≡ Minefield	↑ Rifle Positions	
≡≡≡ Barbed Wire	↑ LMG	
≡≡≡ Pungi Sticks	↑ MMG	
└ Safe Path	↑ HMG	
⋮ Underground Bunker	⋮ Mortar	

Tunnels and Tunnel Warfare:

Many actions in Vietnam involved tunnels and tunnel complexes. Several major battles were fought for control of major underground complexes north of Saigon, such as Cu Chi. To simulate this, the NLF player makes a map of the tunnel or complex that he controls at the beginning of the game. This complex can have as many as four different levels, although one or two levels would be considered normal in all but the most elaborate complexes. The number of entrances/exits to the complex can be set by the umpire, or there can be one entrance/exit for every five men in the NLF force.

The map of the tunnel complex is drawn on graph paper and made available to the gamemaster by the owning player. The gamemaster is also informed how many men and what weapons and equipment are within the complex. If men and material are to be in the complex at the beginning of the game, their location must be noted on the map.

Movement in the tunnel complex, other than in main causeways, vault type rooms, and bottlenecks, is done in a crouch or crawl. In the main causeway and vault type rooms, figures can move erect. In bottlenecks, they must crawl.

All movement in the tunnel is plotted on the map by the gamemaster, who informs each player privately of his unit's positions and what they can see.

Tunnels can be entered by US troops in pursuit or by specialists known as Tunnel Rats. US or Non-NLF troops can move a maximum of 1" per turn in unexplored tunnels if without a light, or 2" per move if with a light. Tunnel Rats get an extra inch of maximum movement.

Tunnel exploration by an intruder(s) is conducted between the gamemaster and the player controlling the figure with the gamemaster secretly providing the intruding player with a verbal description of what his figure can see and hear or feel.

Combat may occur in a tunnel complex. Booby traps and primitive detection devices may be placed in tunnels. Frag grenades have twice normal effect when used within a tunnel, but there is a 20% chance of the tunnel collapsing for a distance of 2" in each direction from the detonation point. WP grenades act the same as on the surface and have the same chance to collapse the tunnel as Frag grenades. They also make their CZ area too hot to enter for about an hour (70-120 turns). Concussion grenades have a CZ = 6". Subtract two from the roll for wound type. They have the same chance to collapse tunnels as Frag grenades. For purposes of assessing grenade (all types) casualties, all men in tunnels count as standing.

Demolition charges collapse tunnels to a radius of 4" from the point of detonation and have their KZ and CZ increased by a factor of four. Subtract one from their casualty die roll, and subtract two from the wound type die roll. Anyone caught in the area where a tunnel collapses is killed.

It should be noted that while a flashlight would help an intruder to see where he was going and increase his speed, it also makes a great target for anyone in the dark.



NVA REGULAR - 1968

Aircraft:

Attacks by aircraft are called in by an FO as indirect fire, unless the target is clearly visible to the plane (clearly visible to the attacking plane can mean that the target's location is clearly visible, although the object of military value might not be, as a gun firing from inside a house where the house is visible to the aircraft but the gun is not.). All FO rules apply. Smoke or flares can be used to give the plane a clearly visible attack point.

Aircraft Types:

Prop Attack Planes (e.g., A1D) - four 20mm cannon, 4000 lb.
 Jet Attack Planes (e.g., F105) - 20mm Vulcan, 10,000 lb.
 B52 - 32 tons of bombs
 Helicopter Gun Ships - 2 Mini guns, 48 2.75" rockets
 Puff (AC47) - 3 Mini guns, up to 12 flares (equivalent to 8")

Types of attacks: Low level and high level, plus slow copter attack. B52's use high level attacks, all other fixed wing aircraft use low level attack. Puff's are special.

High Level Attack - This mode of attack can only be done with bombs. The bombs fall in a pattern (or 'stick'). The pattern can be up to 10" wide and as long as desired, but it must be straight. Placement of bombs within the pattern must be regular. There is a 1/6 chance the pattern will hit the correct spot, otherwise, the pattern scatters from 1" to 20" in a random direction. The direction the pattern points will always be the player specified.

Low Level Attack - This mode of attack depends on the weapon. For direct hits, bombs (including napalm) have 1/6 chance to hit the Aiming Point. Otherwise, they scatter 1" to 10" in a random direction. Rockets have 1/3 chance to hit the Aiming Point. Otherwise, they will scatter 1" to 6". When strafing, each one hundred rounds gives a burst area of a 2" radius circle. For casualty type roll it acts as the CZ of an HE round. There is 1/2 chance that the circle is at the Aiming Point. Otherwise, it scatters 1" to 3" in a random direction. Vulcan and Mini-gun each fire six bursts per attack. Other guns fire one burst per gun per attack.

Copters can perform low level attacks with rockets or strafing, or fire as if they were a moving vehicle. All attacks as if a moving vehicle count as direct fire. Mini-guns have strafing effect without any chance of scatter. Rockets count as 106mm RR for To Hit Roll. If using the moving vehicle attack mode, anti-aircraft fire at the copter is treated as fire at a moving vehicle for To Hit Roll.



HUEY OVER KONTUM - 1967

AIRBORNE WEAPONS EFFECTS:

General Purpose Bombs (HE): This is a fairly thin skinned bomb used against targets such as troops, vehicles, buildings, bridges, unarmored ships, etc. Other types of bombs such as SAP (semiarmor piercing) and armor piercing have thicker skins and less explosive, but were not widely used in Southeast Asia and will not be covered in these rules. The general purpose bomb comes in sizes from 250 to 3,000 pounds. The most common sizes for use against troops, etc., are the 500 and 750 pound sizes.

SIZE	NM	KZ	CZ
250#	1"	4"	9"
500#	1-1/2"	6"	12"
750#	1-1/2"	7"	14"
1000#	2"	8"	16"
2000#	2-1/2"	10"	20"
3000#	2-1/2"	11"	22"

Count general purpose bombs as HE shells for effects. 250# counts as an 8" shell, for larger bombs all near misses kill all personnel, destroy all soft vehicles, heavy weapons, etc., and have a 2/3 chance to destroy armored vehicles. Armored vehicles in the near miss zone that are not destroyed are disabled, plus roll for crew casualties from the concussion as if the vehicle was penetrated by a normal size (no adjustments) HE round. All direct hits destroy the target.

NAPALM: This is dropped in bombs and covers an area of roughly rectangular shape. It burns for three turns, and all troops within the area are casualties. All soft vehicles and open-topped armored vehicles in the area are destroyed. There is a 50% chance for enclosed armored vehicles to be destroyed each turn they are within the area. Bunkers with very small apertures count as enclosed armored vehicles.

SIZE OF NAPALM BOMB	AREA
500#	3" x 12"
750#	3" x 15"
1000#	4" x 14"

The long axis of the area is in the direction of the aircraft's flight path. The Aiming Point is on the center of the short axis and at a quarter point of the long axis, with the greater length in the direction the plane is heading.

ROCKETS: Two sizes are available, 2.75" and 5". The Navy uses the larger size, but the Air Force only uses the smaller. The 5" rockets are designed for use against targets such as ships, so for ground support, the 2.75" is used almost exclusively. They are carried in pods which can fire single rockets, salvos of two, four, or the whole pod. The most common size of pod for aircraft (other than copters) is nineteen rockets, and the loaded pod weighs approximately 650 pounds. Each rocket (2.75") has the effect of a light mortar shell, plus it will penetrate anything it hits directly. (Anything of reasonable thickness, such as tanks or bunkers. There was no Maginot Line in Southeast Asia.) For vehicles, use the normal damage roll with no adjustments.

PUFF: On one pass an AC47 covers an area of 4" x 12". The rectangle has its long axis in the direction of the flight path. There is no scatter, and it causes casualties as if in the KZ of an HE round with a plus one to the die roll adjustment. Note: This is only for whether or not a figure is a casualty. The casualty type table has Puff in it.

Note on strafing and Puff: These are 7.62mm, .50 cal, and 20mm. For penetration of armored vehicles, count as if at point blank range. Against open-topped vehicles, there is a 1/2 chance for rounds to penetrate through the open top as well as the normal side penetration.

TEAR GAS GRENADES:

The U.S. has always considered tear gas to be a "riot control agent", rather than a "war gas", and as such, excluded from the conventions against gas warfare. Few other nations agree with this (no other major one publicly does, but all will use tear gas against their own citizens in riots, which is interesting).

Because the U.S. does not consider tear gas as a war gas, it was used in Vietnam. Only grenades were used, and they were only used for special purposes, such as in cities, tunnels, or against enemy troops mixed with civilians. If tear gas had not been authorized for a particular mission, it would take a long time to get permission to use it if it should later appear to be desirable, as permission could only be granted at an extremely high level. For gaming purposes, the U.S. should only have tear gas along if they are clearing tunnels, operating in a city, or if the gamemaster has specifically set up a scenario in which it will be authorized.

Tear gas grenades effect any unmasked personnel within the area of the gas cloud. In the open the cloud covers an area equal to a smoke grenade, and moves and dissipates like smoke. In tunnels, tear gas covers an area 12" long, in other enclosed spaces (inside rooms, etc.), it covers an area of 13 square inches. In enclosed spaces, the gas lasts 15 moves, then the gamemaster starts rolling each turn to see if the gas dissipates, 1/6 chance per turn.

Personnel within a tear gas area must either mask or leave the area within one turn or they count as dazed, except that they may move, attempting to get out of the area. They may be led along at 1/2 movement allowance or they can stumble along themselves at 1/4 movement allowance. If they are not led, there is a 1/2 chance they will move in a random direction, i.e., they have lost their sense of direction as well as being half-blinded. They do not begin to make recovery rolls until they are out of the tear gas cloud or area. No unmasked personnel will voluntarily remain in a tear gas cloud.



Troop Types:

The following is a list of "Who's Who" in the South-East Asian Theater of Operations.

U.S. Elite - These are Special Forces, Rangers, Seal Teams, Air Force Air Commando Units, Marines Spearhead Units, Air America (CIA) personnel, and LRRP (Long Range Recon Patrol) Teams.

U.S. Regulars - Airborne or Airmobile Troops and some Marine units were predominantly regulars. A few of these units were the 1st Air Cavalry Division, the 101st Airborne (Airmobile) Division, and the 173rd and 197th Airborne Brigades (independent).

U.S. "Draftees" - These were the bulk of the Army Infantry and some Marine Units. Any enlisted man over the rank of Sergeant E5 (buck sergeant) would probably be a regular but most of the rest would be draftees or personnel who only joined up because they were about to be drafted. Most of the junior officers would be ROTC graduates. The unit as a whole would not be quite as steady as a regular unit.

ARVN Elite - ARVN stands for Army of the Republic of Vietnam (South Vietnam). ARVN elite troops were the LLDB (special forces), rangers, paratroopers, and marines. They were generally as professional as U.S. regulars, and many served in the French Army during the earlier Indochinese War or even in the Foreign Legion. They had the habit of seldom taking prisoners.

ARVN Regulars - Supposedly professionals, many of them were draftees. Their Performance was highly variable but in general they were equivalent to U.S. draftees.

ARVN Local Forces - These were roughly the equivalent of medieval peasant militia. They were known as "strikers" to U.S. forces. They had a very high desertion rate which adversely effected even the most reliable striker units.

Montagniards - These were inhabitants of the central highlands of South Vietnam. Armed and trained by U.S. Special Forces, they proved to be good troops, but hated the lowlanders inexpressibly, (whether ARVN or VC) so they could not be used together with ARVN units. If they did encounter ARVN troops, they were likely to start fighting them. (The lowlanders hated and despised the Montagniards in return.)

Nungs - Before the war they lived in Cambodia near the border and existed by banditry. They soon found acting as mercenaries was more profitable and were among the best troops in SEA. The CIA recruited them and generally borrowed Special Forces personnel to train them. In combat they were led by Special Forces or Air America personnel.

Meos - Originally from Laos, they were recruited, trained and equipped by the U.S. (CIA with help from Special Forces) and used in Laos and Vietnam. They usually had their own officers.

ROK Regulars - ROK stands for Republic of Korea (South Korea). Several ROK units fought in Vietnam including the Tiger Division and a ROK Marine brigade. ROK troops were well trained, the ones sent to Vietnam were really elites. They had a reputation for not taking prisoners.

Australian Regulars - There were approximately 28,000 Australian troops in Vietnam at one time. They were about the same as U.S. Regulars.

New Zealand Regulars - A brigade of New Zealanders served in Vietnam. They were about the same as the Australians in training, organization, equipment and morale.

NVA Regulars - NVA means North Vietnamese Army. All NVA troops sent south were regulars. They were well trained and equipped, but just as prone to get lost in the south as any U.S. unit.

NLF Cadre - NLF means National Liberation Front, which is the same as the Viet Cong (VC) or Charlie as they were called by U.S. troops. Cadre troops were hard core elites, many being Viet Minh veterans. They were assigned many of the high risk operations where political dedication overrode the instinct of self-preservation.

NLF Regulars (Line) - These were the main strength of the VC army. Although well trained, they lacked the dedication of cadre personnel. Their morale was about equal to U.S. regulars.

NLF Local Forces - These were the VC version of Peoples' Militia. They operated only in their home territory and were primarily used in defense and harrasing operations, or to provide local guides and bearers for Line or Cadre units operating in their area.

Pathet Lao Cadre - These were the backbone of the Laotian communist organization. They were well trained and equipped, supplied directly from North Vietnam, and politically dedicated.

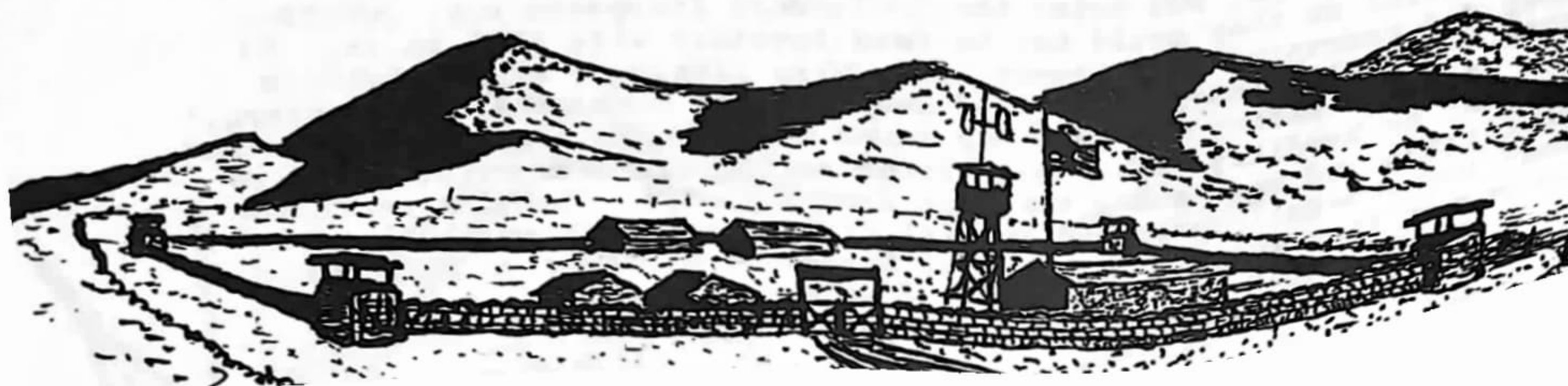
Pathet Lao Regulars - The rank and file of the Pathet Lao, these troops were the equivalent of ARVN regulars in morale.

Khmere Rouge - These were the Cambodian equivalent of the VC. They tended toward fanaticism, but did not revolt against the Cambodian government in strength until Lon Nol overthrew the neutralist government which had allowed the NLF sanctuary and bases along the border.

Cambodian Government Troops - Generally poor fighters, they were no match for the Khmere Rouge, or even ARVN troops.

Royal Laotian Government Troops - The troops of the Laotian right wing, (the Neutralists who were the nominal ruling party had little or no military forces), they were similar to Cambodian Government troops in training and morale.

Note: Both Cambodian government troops and Royal Laotian troops are given in the morale class table as class C, but they are actually C minus, or even D plus.



Typical Organization, Weapons and Ammo

These matters are of great interest to wargamers, for without them it is impossible to set up accurate scenarios. Unfortunately, this information can be difficult to obtain. While this section will not give a definitive listing, it should provide enough for most games.

Remember the rates of fire of all weapons were reduced in these rules and their effectiveness (single round) was increased for playability, therefore, the ammunition loads given here are also reduced to account for that.

There were five kinds of U.S. Army Infantry units in Nam: Light, Airborne, Airmobile, Mechanized and Regular. At the squad and platoon level there was little if any difference between them, and their organization at company and battalion level was similar. In addition, there were Armored Cavalry (ACAV) units, Armored (Tank) units, Special Forces Teams and LRRP Teams.

U.S. units tended to vary their organization in the field, changing the official TO&E (Table of Organization and Equipment) considerably. In Vietnam, this was complicated by the fact that most of the units there were under modified TO&E's (MTOE's), which had a tendency to change rapidly.

Almost all of the infantry units used a ten-man squad, the exception being the Mech (mechanized) Infantry which had eleven men per squad. The squads each had two fire teams, one of four and one of five men, plus a squad leader. An alternate to this was two fire teams of four each, a squad leader and his RTO (radiotelephone operator) being the other two. The Mech squad's extra man was the driver of the APC (armored personnel carrier) which each squad had. An additional man stayed with the APC as a gunner for the .50 cal MG when the squad dismounted, leaving only nine for dismounted operations.

Each fire team had a grenadier with an M79 (Thumper) and a .45 cal pistol. The rest of the men had rifles or automatic rifles. Prior to 1967, there would be two automatic riflemen with M14 modifieds, and the rest of the men would have M14's. Some M3 SMG's were used, and occasionally shotguns were issued. Around 1968, the M16 was issued and replaced the M14's, the M14 modifieds, and the M3's. During the change over period AR15's were common, but AR10's were also in use. Actually, the AR15 was the "field-test" weapon from which the decision to issue the M16's was made. Unfortunately, the first M16's developed severe jamming problems (due to a change in the powder used in the ammunition between the time of the testing of the weapon and its widespread issue) and was unpopular with the troops for several years. The M16's bad reputation remained for some time after the problem was solved.

The platoon had three rifle squads (as described above) and a weapons squad, plus a platoon headquarters which usually had a mortar forward observer attached. The company had three platoons plus a weapons platoon with three mortars and, in some cases, two 106mm Recoilless Rifles. All U.S. units had a radio for each squad, plus extras at platoon and company level. Each APC also had a radio.

The weapons squad had two LMG's (M60's) plus two Antitank weapons (90mm RR), with a total of eleven men. The MTOE's changed this, and the weapons squad had different organizations. The 90mm RR's were often replaced either by LAW's, (which were also issued to infantrymen as required) or by one or two extra M60's. Some units converted the weapons squad into another rifle squad, others simply ignored it since they were usually at 75% strength or less, and used the extra men to try and keep three squads up to strength. Placing the M60's in the rifle squads was common, so a "typical" squad might have eight to twelve men with one M60, two M79's (the grenadiers also had pistols), and the rest with rifles or autorifles.

LRRP teams were organized in eight-man squads, with four squads to the platoon and no heavy weapons. The squad typically had one grenadier, a shotgun, and six rifles or autorifles. Before the AR15 was available, LRRP's used a variety of weapons since most men didn't like the M14 for LRRP operations.

CAR-15's were frequently used by helicopter crews, vehicle crews, and some officers. Prior to about 1967, air crews usually used M2 carbines and tank crews M3 SMG's. M2 carbines and M3 SMG's were sometimes used by Special Forces personnel, particularly before the AR15's were issued. Many troops favored automatic shotguns, particularly recon and Marine Spearhead units. The M14 sniper version remained in service after all the regular M14's had been replaced.

U.S. troops carried loads of ammo. (Remember these numbers are modified to correspond to the changes in the rates of fire!) Troops on foot would carry approximately 100 to 200 rounds per rifle or auto-rifle (when the M14 modified was used, the men with the M14's would carry ammo for the Automatic rifleman), 120 to 180 rounds per SMG, 2 or 3 belts per LMG, about 18 rounds per grenadier, 2 magazines (14 rounds) per pistol, 36 to 50 rounds per shotgun, and 2 to 4 grenades per man. LAWs would be issued as required, usually when attacking fortified positions with bunkers, and 90mm RR's (when used) had 4 to 6 rounds each. Units usually carried a couple of claymores per squad for use in ambushes and temporary defense, and sometimes carried trip-flares. Demolition charges were issued as required. Tear gas grenades were not common issue, being used only in tunnels and on special operations, such as in cities. The decision to issue and employ tear gas was only made at a very high level.

Mech units and any other troops with vehicles available carried extra ammo on the vehicles. Between one and three full extra loads on the vehicle were common. U.S. (and Allied) forces also used helicopters to resupply units with ammo.

Armored units saw more service in Vietnam than is generally realized. Much of northern South Vietnam (I Corp) is "tank country" and armor was widely used for convoy escort throughout the country. A tank platoon had 5 tanks, a company 17 tanks in three platoons, plus a headquarters. For game purposes it can be assumed that U.S. armored vehicles never run out of ammo.

The armored cavalry (ACAV) platoon is a combined arms force and proved very effective in Nam. The ACAV company (or troop) had three platoons. Each platoon had 3 tanks, an infantry (mech) squad on a M113 APC, a platoon headquarters on a M113, a heavy (4.2") mortar squad on a M113, and 4 scout vehicles. In the early 1960's the light tank was the M41. This was replaced in the mid and late 60's by the M551 "Sheridan" armored recon vehicle, which developed problems as explained previously and was usually replaced by the M48. The scout vehicle was the M114, but it too developed problems (as mentioned under vehicles) and was replaced with the M113-ACAV. The ACAV platoon, therefore, usually had 3 tanks (M551 or M48) and 6 M113-ACAV (the infantry squad was used to fill out the crews) and one M113 with a 4.2" mortar (when they were at full strength).

Special Forces "A" Teams were used to train Vietnamese and mercenary forces. An A Team had two officers and ten enlisted men. It would typically train and lead several hundred local troops. The Special Forces Troops were well armed, even when the local forces carried WWII weapons. Several of the A Team members would count as medics due to their cross-training.

As was mentioned previously, U.S. forces were usually below strength (as were everyone else's) which caused some of the organization modifications mentioned. A rifle platoon should have 44 men, plus a 2-man mortar FO team and 2 medics attached. Counting all causes why men were absent (including R & R), U.S. platoons in Nam usually had twenty to thirty men present, and sometimes less. Tank companies of ten or twelve tanks were common, and ACAV units were usually missing several vehicles.

The U.S. Marines used a different TO&E from the army. Marine squads (at full strength) had fourteen men, a squad leader with a rifle, a grenadier, and three fire teams of four men, each with three riflemen (M14's) and an automatic rifleman (M14 modified). Around 1968, the M14's and M14 modifieds were replaced by M16's.

Marine platoons had three squads with no heavy weapons squad, while companies had three platoons plus a weapons platoon with six M60 machine guns and six anti-tank weapons (Bazookas or 90mm RR). Mortars were at battalion level. The Marines were much more prone to use the M60 as a MMG (with tripod), as opposed to a LMG (with bipod), than the Army.

ARVN regular and elite units and ROK units followed the U.S. Army pattern of organization (except ARVN and ROK marines, which followed the U.S. Marine pattern). Prior to 1968, most of these troops used WWII weapons, then they were issued M16's, etc. The ROK units still carried a large number of M3 SMG's even after they got M16's. They carried a little less ammo than U.S. troops.

ARVN local forces either followed the U.S. pattern (loosely) or were led by Special Forces A Teams as described previously. The strikers usually had WWII weapons, but some got M16's later in the war.

Nungs and Montagniards were led by Special Forces. They were armed like ARVN units. The Meos' organization was variable, they were armed like the ARVN, except the Montagniards liked to use crossbows for silent weapons. All of these carried less ammo than U.S. troops, but not much less.

Australian and New Zealander units used a British pattern organization. Squads had eight men with FN-FAL rifles, FN-FALO autorifles, Sten or Austin SMG's, and FN-MAG machineguns. The FAL was similar to a M14, the FALO like the M14 modified. They carried about the same ammo as U.S. troops.

The NVA squad had eight men at full strength. The platoon had four squads, a company had three platoons plus a weapons platoon with light mortars.

The NVA was armed with the Russian-made SKS semiautomatic carbine, the AK47 assault rifle, the RPD LMG, the RPG, and the North Vietnamese Type 50 SMG. Squads had one LMG, one RPG, and the rest had SMG's, SKS's, or AK47's. The AK47 was rare at first, but became the most common small arm in the squad after 1968.

NLF Cadre and Line units had the same organization as the NVA, except they had an additional man in each squad, a "political officer". The cadre units were armed the same as the NVA, the line units got the AK47's only after the Cadre and NVA already had them. All the NLF units would use captured weapons as well, but the line and cadre units usually had communist-made small arms.

The NVA and NLF cadre and line carried less ammo than the Allied troops. They usually had (remember this is modified to reflect the rate of fire changes!) about 60 to 120 rounds per rifle or SMG, 2 magazines per pistol, 240 to 400 rounds per LMG, 2 to 4 rounds per RPG, and one or two grenades per man.

VC local defense units were organized into battalions, each roughly 1200 men. (Very roughly, many had less even at full strength and some had many more. The Cu Chi Defense Battalion had over 60,000 men assigned to it at one time.) They were split up into platoons of thirty to sixty men. They were armed with anything at all, from WWII Russian weapons to captured French weapons from the earlier Indochinese War to captured ARVN weapons to SKS's and AK47's and Type 50 SMG's. They had less ammo than the NVA, and were often short of ammo. For gaming, they can be assumed to have about half as much as NVA units.

The Pathet Lao units were organized, armed and supplied (amount of ammo) like the NLF. Their line units were likely to have old weapons.

The Khmère Rouge, Cambodian Government and Royal Laotian Government troops were armed with anything at all, and were usually short of ammo.

Note: The strengths given for units in this are the official TO&E strengths. Most units were normally at 50% to 75% of the official strength and sometimes less.

GEOGRAPHY OF SOUTHEAST ASIA

South Vietnam was divided up into four corps areas. I (eye) corps was in the extreme north along the DMZ, II (deuce) corps was just south of I corps, III (trey) corps was just south of II corps and included Saigon, and IV (four) corps was the Mekong Delta and everything south of it.

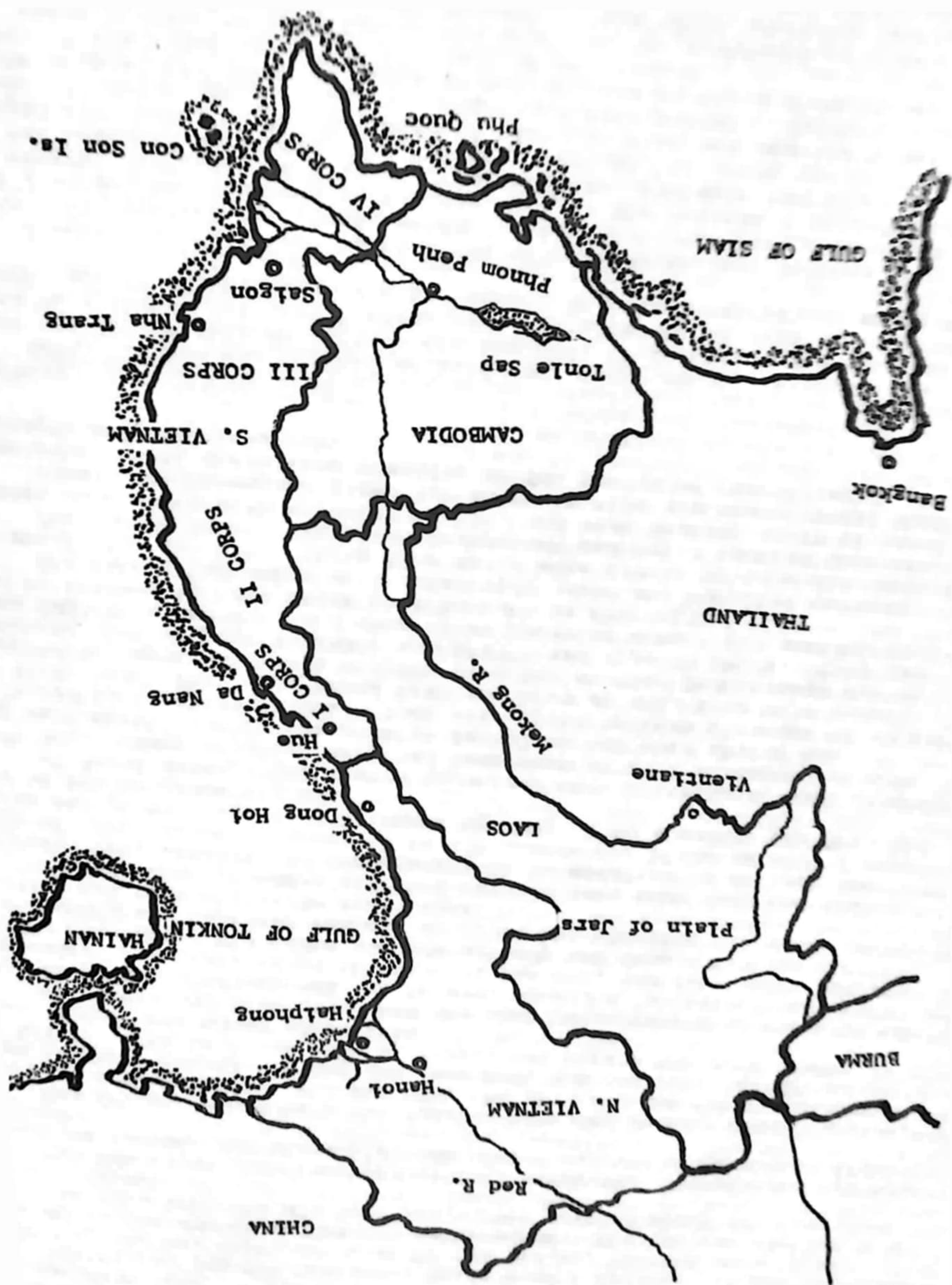
I corps was hilly and mountainous with large valleys between the hills. The valleys are "tank country". II corps' northern region was like I corps, the southern region was part of the central highlands. The central highlands is a large, flat plateau, suitable for tanks if you can get them up there. The northern part of III corps was in the central highlands, while the southern part was flat and heavily vegetated. IV corps was all swamps, jungle and rain forest. Vegetation in the central highlands is light to medium, and north of them it is light. I corps was known for its lack of vegetation.

North Vietnam is mountainous and hilly to the northwest, plains with low hills in the rest of the country. Vegetation is heavy along the Red River, medium to heavy along the southern coast, and mostly medium with some light in the rest of the country.

Laos is very mountainous, except in the Mekong Valley. The valley is jungle and rain forest, vegetation ranges from light to heavy in the mountains. The Plain of Jars covers about a quarter of the northwest area of Laos, and is fairly a flat plateau with light to medium vegetation.

Cambodia is mostly flat except in the southwest, which has low hills and rough terrain. The hills have medium to heavy vegetation, the rest of the country is dense jungle and rain forest.

Thailand's eastern edge is dense rain forest.



GLOSSARY

A	Automatic
AA	Anti-aircraft
ACAV	Armored Cavalry
AFV	Armored Fighting Vehicle
ARVN	Army of the Republic of Viet Nam (South Viet Nam)
AT	Anti-tank
C	Contact
CZ	Casualty Zone
DF	Direct Fire
Ext.	Extreme
FA	Field Artillery
FO	Forward Observer
GL	Grenade Launcher
H	Horizon
HE	High Explosive
HMG	Heavy Machine Gun
How	Howitzer
Hv	Heavy
Hvy	Heavy
IDF	Indirect Fire
Inf	Infantry
LAW	Light Anti-tank Weapon
LMG	Light Machine Gun
Lt	Light
LRRP	Long Range Recon Patrol
Mag	Magazine
Max	Maximum
Md	Medium
Mdm	Medium
MF	Movement Factor
MG	Machine Gun
Min	Minimum
MMG	Medium Machine Gun
Mtr	Mortar
NCO	Noncommissioned officer
NLF	National Liberation Front
NM	Near Miss
NVA	North Vietnamese Army
Perm	Permanent
ROF	Rate of Fire
ROK	Republic of Korea
RL	Rocket Launcher
RPG	Rocket Propelled Grenade
RR	Recoilless Rifle
SMG	Submachine gun
Stat	Stationary
Temp	Temporary
TO&E	Table of Organization and Equipment
VC	Viet Cong
WP	White Phosphorus (Willy Peter)
Wpns	Weapons
KZ	Kill Zone
AR	Automatic Rifle
AW	Automatic Weapon

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GI'AC MY